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Oti, John Kwabena Bless — NDC	<i>Nkwanta North</i>
Owiredu, Charles Asuako — NPP	<i>Abirem</i>
Owusu, Gloria, (Ms) — NPP	<i>Trobu</i>
Owusuah, Rachel Amma, (Ms) — NDC	<i>Dormaa East</i>
Owusu-Akyaw, Francis Kwabena Berepong — NPP	<i>Juaben</i>

P

Paitoo, Desmond De-Graft — NDC	<i>Gomoa East</i>
Pelpuo, Abdul-Rashid Hassan, (Dr) — NDC	<i>Wa Central</i>
Poku-Adusei, Ralph, Esq. — NPP	<i>Bekwai</i>

Q

Quashie, Joycelyn, (Mrs) — NDC	<i>North Dayi</i>
Quayson, James Gyakye — NDC	<i>Assin North</i>

R

Ramadan, Mohammed Adamu — NDC	<i>Adentan</i>
Ricketts-Hagan, George Kweku — NDC	<i>Cape Coast South</i>

S

Salam, Damata Ama Appianimaa, (Ms) — NPP	<i>Afigya Kwabre South</i>
Sandaare, Sebastian Ngmenenso, (Dr) — NDC	<i>Daffiama/Bussie/Issa</i>
Sawyer, Queenstar Maame Pokua, (Mrs) — NDC	<i>Agona East</i>
Sefe, Richard Kwami — NDC	<i>Anlo</i>
Shaib, Jerry Ahmed, Esq. — NPP	<i>Weija-Gbawe</i>
Sosu, Francis-Xavier Kojo, Esq. — NDC	<i>Madina</i>
Sowah, Rita Naa Odoley, (Ms) — NDC	<i>Dadekotopon</i>
Sukparu, Adams Mohammed — NDC	<i>Sissala West</i>
Sulemana, Adama — NDC	<i>Tain</i>
Sulemana, Alhassan Tampuli, Esq. — NPP	<i>Gushiegu</i>
Sulemana, Yusif, (Alhaji) — NDC	<i>Bole/Bamboi</i>
Sumah, Anthony Mwinkaara — NDC	<i>Nadowli/Kaleo</i>

T

Taylor, Issah Salifu — NDC	<i>Tarkwa/Nsuaem</i>
Terlabi, Ebenezer Okletey — NDC	<i>Lower Manya Krobo</i>
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Tettey, Joseph Akuerteh — NDC	<i>Kpone-Katamanso</i>
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Toobu, Peter Lanchene, (Supt Rtd) — NDC	<i>Wa West</i>
Tsekpo, Thomas Worlanyo — NDC	<i>Hohoe</i>
Tubazu, Abdul Rauf Tongym — NDC	<i>Ayawaso Central</i>

U

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 Ussif, Mustapha — NPP*Yagaba/Kubori*

V

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W

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Y

Yeboah, Frank — NPP*Atwima Nwabiagya North*
 Yibor, Isaac Awuku — NDC*Domeabra Obom*

Z

Ziedeng, Bede Anwataazumo, Esq. — NDC*Lawra*

SUMMARY OF PARLIAMENTARY SEATS

	Men	Women	Seats
National Democratic Congress (NDC)	153	31	184
New Patriotic Party (NPP)	77	10	87
Independent	4	0	4
TOTAL	234	41	275*

*Ayawaso East — Vacant

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6. Angela Obeng Ntiamoah (Mrs).....Assistant Director IIA
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8. Arnold Kamwinenang Kon-Agna.....Assistant Director IIB
9. Prince Kwakye.....Reporter I
10. Priscilla Elikem Sevor (Ms)Reporter I
11. Josephine Yartey (Ms).....Senior Private Secretary
12. Rhoderick Abbey.....Chief Administrative Assistant
13. Samuel Osei.....Principal Usher
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Obed Appiah.....Senior Public Affairs Officer

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3. Juliet Afia Adoma Kwarteng (Ms)Assistant Records & Archives Officer III
4. Charles Adjartey.....Senior Executive Officer
5. Cletus Kofi Awumey.....Clerical Assistant

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3. William Justice Acquah.....(Secondment).....Museum & Monuments Education Officer
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5. Pearl Adzaho (Ms)Assistant Director III
6. Emmanuel Appiagyei LarbiAssistant Director III
7. Lawrence Ato Executive Officer

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3. Haruna Ziententah.....Assistant Parliamentary Relations Officer II

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3. Isaac Tornam Kwasi Ablordeppey, Esq.....Legal Officer
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6. Patience Quansah (Mrs)..... Stenographer
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5. Amma Okyerebea Larbi (Ms)*Assistant Director IIA*
6. Prince Milonu. *Assistant Research Officer I*
7. Bertrand Zieme Anzagra *Assistant Director II*
8. Godwin Worlanyo Asimenu.....*Assistant Director III*

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2. Hillary Pearl Cudjoe (Ms)*Assistant Risk Officer I*
3. Emmanuel Klutse..... *Assistant Director III*
4. Janet Mante (Ms)*Stenographer*

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4. Yvonne Safo (Ms).....*Assistant Internal Auditor III*
5. Francisca Naa Odorkor Ashong (Ms)*Assistant Administrative Secretary IV*
6. Edwin Obeng.....*Assistant Internal Auditor III*
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3. Peter Binipom Mpuan..... *Reporter I*
4. Wisdom Asamany*Senior Executive Officer*

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3. Emmanuel Ewusi Otoo.....*Assistant Director III*
4. Sherika Taasung Salam (Ms)*Clerical Officer*

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- 4 *Anthony Ayensu-Asare.....(Contract).....Dir. Speaker's Security Support
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- 7 Esther Donkor (Ms)Senior Administrative Secretary
- 8 Joshua Otu Anim.....Deputy Director (Administration)
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- 10 David Jawara Banye..(Contract).....Assistant Intelligence Officer
- 11 Justice Dansu Novor.....(Contract).....Personal Aide to Speaker
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- 13 Saaka WahiduAssistant Accounting Officer III
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- 16 Janet Afrifa Amankwah (Mrs)(Contract).....Assistant Director III (Communication Officer)
- 17 Maxwell Dzebu.....(Contract).....Assistant ICT Officer III
- 18 Ezekiel Birikorang.....Chief Usher
- 19 Linda Emefa Aku Dzinyakpor (Ms)Private Secretary
- 20 Godwin Buckman.....Assistant Chief Usher
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- 22 Emmanuel Ladzagla.....Senior Executive Officer
- 23 Anita Ahiney Adjetey (Ms)Senior Executive Officer
- 24 Frederick William De-Clerk Annan.....Clerical Officer
- 25 Ernest Saka Yeboah.....Clerical Officer
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4. Mary Afriyie (Ms)Assistant Clerk III
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6. Bernard Nii Armah Ayibontey.....Assistant Director III
7. Mercansile Adjoa Addisu (Ms)Assistant Director III
8. Delali Otutey Anim.....Senior Executive Officer

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2. Shiela Okine (Ms)(Contract).....Stenographer Secretary
3. Amina Kabore Hamidu (Ms)(Contract).....Stenographer Secretary
4. Sonia Ama Akpene Adeku (Ms)(Contract).....Stenographer Secretary

5. Abigail Maadey Amediku (Ms)(Contract).....Stenographer Secretary
6. Doreen Agyiri Asare (Ms)..... (Contract)..... Stenographer Secretary
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8. Samuel Morris Batsa Guamah.....(Contract).....Usher

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2. Maxwell Boateng Asare..... (Contract).....Research Officer
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4. Sarah Kukua Amissah Clement (Ms)Contract).....Stenographer Secretary
5. Francis Junior Dickson..... (Contract).....Stenographer Secretary
6. Isaac Nana Acheampong Koranteng..... (Contract).....Usher
7. Maleene Ama Gyasiwah Mensah (Ms) (Contract).....Usher

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5. Pascaline Adamu-Koto (Ms)Assistant Clerk III
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7. Samuella Serwaa Bonsu Asamoah (Ms)Assistant Clerk III
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9. Faustina Tantie (Ms)Reporter I (Proof-Reader)
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6. Beatrice Naa Dei Neequaye (Ms)Assistant Clerk III
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6. Bennet Appiah Twumasi.....Assistant Clerk III
7. Nana Agyemang-Prempeh.....Reporter I
8. Martha Asantewaa Boateng (Ms)Reporter I (Proofreader)
9. Grace Korkoi Esinam Folley (Ms)Reporter I
10. Rebecca Ofori (Ms)Stenographer Secretary

Special Committees Cluster

1. Emmanuel Koranteng.....Principal Assistant Clerk
2. Dzifa Azaglo (Ms)Senior Assistant Clerk
3. Sapaku Gaou.....Assistant Clerk III
4. Annastecia Konadu Boah (Ms)Sub-Editor II
5. Janet Anima Osei (Ms)Reporter I

Economy Cluster

1. Abdallah Ibrahim Gariba.....Principal Assistant Clerk
2. Juliette Akua Serwaa Adum-Attah (Ms)Senior Assistant Clerk
3. Jimmy Numanyi Jafah.....Assistant Clerk III
4. Michael Tetteh.....Assistant Clerk III
5. Gifty Haja Sumani (Ms).....Reporter I
6. Deborah Adu Gyamfi (Ms)Reporter I (Proofreader)

Public Administration Cluster

1. Ayisha Salifu (Hajia)Principal Assistant Clerk
2. Patrick Osei Adonteng.....Senior Assistant Clerk

3. Stella Esi Anthony (Ms) *Assistant Clerk III*
4. Peace Krupskaya Bomansaan (Ms) *Assistant Clerk III*
5. Belinda Mawukomayor Ahugah (Ms) *Reporter I*
6. Sarah Pinkrah (Mrs) *Sub-Editor III*

CORPORATE AND FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT SERVICES DIVISION

Gloria Akua Sarku Kumawu (Dr) (Mrs) *Deputy Clerk*

C&FMS Secretariat

1. Abraham Sarpong Owusu *Assistant Research Officer II*
2. Davidson Kwabena Techie-Menson *Reporter I*
3. Rejoice Adzo Bukari (Ms) *Stenographer Secretary*

HUMAN RESOURCE, ADMINISTRATION AND GENERAL SERVICES SUB-DIVISION

Wilhelmina Sylvia Aidoo (Ms) *Coordinating Director*

Human Resource Department

1. Cornelia Puobi-Akumpule (Mrs) *Director*
2. Parvati W. Baidoo Opoku (Mrs) *Deputy Director*
3. Emeffa Nadia Fiakpui (Ms) *(Secondment) Deputy Director*
4. Maame Aba Baiden (Ms) *Deputy Director*
5. John Paul Tetteh Doku *Deputy Director*
6. Maame Afia Annoh-Dompreh (Mrs) *Deputy Director*
7. Harriet Agyei-Agyare (Ms) *(Secondment) Assistant Director I*
8. Nancy Ohene-Safo (Ms) *Human Resource Officer*
9. Abigail Ofosu Okyere (Ms) *Assistant Director IIA*
10. Gloria Akoma Donkor (Ms) *Human Resource Officer*
11. Isaac Frimpong-Kusi-Siaw *Assistant Human Resource Officer III*
12. Yasmine Fatime Kamagate (Ms) *Assistant Human Resource Officer III*
13. Faiza Yakubu Abdul Aziz (Ms) *Assistant Human Resource Officer III*
14. Christiana Amankwah (Ms) *Assistant Human Resource Officer III*
15. Ruth Gyetuah (Ms) *Senior Private Secretary*
16. Gladys Asamani (Ms) *Principal Executive Officer*
17. Richard Amoaning *Clerical Officer*
18. Bright Narh *Clerical Officer*

Administration Department

1. Sabrah Yahaya (Ms) *Deputy Director*
2. Ruby Yaa Korantiwaa Akae (Ms) *(Secondment) Deputy Director*
3. Edith Osman (Ms) *Deputy Director*
4. Catherine Apenyo (Mrs) *Senior Administrative Secretary*
5. Christabel Gyamera-Tawiah (Ms) *(Secondment) Assistant Director I*
6. Linda Sedinam Amewu (Ms) *Assistant Director IIA*
7. Alberta Ofori (Ms) *Assistant Director IIA*
8. Anita Afi Agbavor (Ms) *Assistant Director IIA*
9. Gertrude Ofori Asare (Ms) *Assistant Director IIA*
10. Dominic Adonye Ziema *Assistant Director III*

11. Alice Mirinda Coleman (Ms)Assistant Director III
12. Ethel Naa Korley Tetteh (Ms)Assistant Administrative Secretary IV
13. Irene Adubea (Ms)Assistant Director III
14. Dorothy Yarquah (Ms)Stenographer (Administration)
15. Doreen Yaa Nick Koffie (Ms)Executive Officer

Psychology Unit

1. Patricia Benson Gaskin (Mrs)Deputy Director, Psychology
2. Samuel Kwesi Adu Ansah Sasraku.....Assistant Director III
3. Helena Agnes Hubert (Ms)Clerical Officer

Gym Unit

1. Alex Yawson.....Assistant Director III
2. George Yaw Gyamfi.....Gym Attendant

Nutrition and Catering Services Department

1. Shirley Florence Tetteh (Ms)Deputy Director
2. Jerry Adu Yirenkyi..... Assistant Director III (Catering)
3. Florence Kesewaa Bedford (Mrs) Chief Catering Officer
4. Justice Kwame Musah..... Principal Catering Officer
5. Sarah Naakie Pinto (Ms)Senior Catering Officer
6. Doris Ziedeng (Ms)Senior Catering Officer
7. Esther Frimpong (Ms)Senior Catering Officer
8. Constance Ayimah OtooSenior Catering Officer
9. Abigail Coffie (Ms)Senior Catering Officer
10. Diana Afriyie Osei (Ms)Senior Catering Officer
11. Doris Betsy Abokoma Clerk (Ms)Senior Catering Officer
12. Solomon Kranpah.....Senior Catering Officer
13. Esther Naa Adjeley Tetteh (Ms).....Senior Catering Officer
14. Joyce Wahab (Ms)Senior Catering Officer
15. Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan..... Catering Officer
16. Richard Osuman Adjartey.....Assistant Catering Officer
17. Margaret Yost Adu (Mrs)Assistant Catering Officer
18. Ruby Peterkin Yanzu (Mrs).....Assistant Catering Officer
19. Gifty Baziing (Ms).....Senior Cook
20. Felicia Dzebu (Ms)Senior Cook
21. Obed Ofoe Dawutey.....Clerical Officer
22. Felicia Oforiwa Nyampong (Ms)Senior Cook
23. Diana Djreh (Ms)Kitchen Staff Supervisor
24. Justice AbbeyStaff Cook
25. Eugenia Aryee (Ms)Staff Cook
26. Gertrude Akua Obo (Ms)Staff Cook
27. Maame Abena Adabi Bawuah (Ms)Senior Steward
28. Solomon Nartey..... Senior Steward
29. Efua Parkoo (Ms)Cook Assistant

Performance, Monitoring & Evaluation Department

1. Nicholas Francis Ayamga (Dr)Director
2. Abdul-Jalilu Alhassan.....(Secondment).....Assistant Director I
3. Claris Efia Quayson (Mrs).....Assistant Director IIA
4. Emma Adobea Opoku Afriyie (Ms)Assistant Director IIA
5. Kwadwo Amoakoh Nsiah.....Assistant Director II

6.	Edmund Dzidefo Hehetror.....	Assistant Director III
7.	Evans Elikem Adjei.....	Assistant Research Officer III
8.	James Quartey Obinnyim.....	Assistant Director III

Transport, Logistics & Stores Department

1.	John Kennedy Babo-Brown.....	Director
2.	Awudu Adams Mumuni.....	Deputy Director
3.	Felix Adom.....	Transport Officer III
4.	Richard K. Amponsah-Odame.....	Chief Transport Assistant
5.	Samuel Acheampong.....	Chief Transport Assistant
6.	Ebenezer Tawiah.....	Chief Transport Assistant
7.	Roland Ofori.....	Chief Transport Assistant
8.	Foster Donkor.....	Chief Driver
9.	Abdul Aziz Mohammed.....	Chief Driver
10.	Samuel Kwame Aweregiya.....	Chief Driver
11.	Isaac Dankwa.....	Chief Driver
12.	Frederick Kumi.....	Chief Driver
13.	Christian Thomas Sam.....	Chief Driver
14.	Isaac Tekper Narh.....	Chief Driver
15.	Gilbert Nana Nyarko.....	Chief Driver
16.	Haruna Bashiru.....	Chief Driver
17.	Prosper Bomansaan.....	Chief Driver
18.	Julius Zigah.....	Chief Driver
19.	Jacob Abunyewah.....	Chief Driver
20.	Benjamin Sackey.....	Chief Driver
21.	Maxwell Asamoah.....	Chief Driver
22.	Sulev Ocran Sackey.....	Chief Driver
23.	Wisdom Agornyo.....	Chief Driver
24.	Frederick Ani-Gyebi.....	Chief Driver
25.	Fred Dacoster Larbi.....	Chief Driver
26.	Ohene Boadu.....	Chief Driver
27.	Abdul-Rashid Musah Samari.....	Chief Driver
28.	Samuel Essel.....	Chief Driver
29.	Dennis Anyomi.....	Chief Driver
30.	Daniel Kwame Adu.....	Assistant Chief Driver
31.	Richard Dickson Ansrodja.....	Assistant Chief Driver
32.	George Asante.....	Assistant Chief Driver
33.	Solomon Dowuona.....	(Contract) Assistant Chief Driver
34.	Albert Kwaku Asiedu.....	Senior Driver
35.	Obed Larbie Kwaku Lartey.....	Driver Gd. I
36.	Daniel Attor.....	Driver Gd. I
37.	Felix Dawutey.....	Driver Gd. I
38.	Abass Seidu Bawa.....	Driver Gd. I
39.	Patrick Asare Adofu.....	Driver Gd. I
40.	Moshood Musah Abiola.....	Driver Gd. I
41.	Kamal Saani.....	Driver Gd. I
42.	Yaw Koduah.....	Driver Gd. I
43.	Danladi Assah.....	Driver Gd. I
44.	Sheriff Adamu Bawa.....	(Contract) Driver Gd. I
45.	Jebuni Bayong Kala.....	(Contract) Driver Gd. II
46.	Adinaan Dauda.....	Driver Gd. II

47. Mohammed Tahiru.....	Driver Gd. II
48. Richard Agyei.....	Driver Gd. II
49. Emmanuel Kwame Anyomi.....	Driver Gd. II
50. Richard Apreku.....	Driver Gd. II
51. Akwasi Sarpong.....	Driver Gd. II
52. Eric Kwasi Frimpong.....	Driver Gd. II
53. Elvis Kormla Dzah.....	Driver Gd. II
54. Toufic Salifu.....	Driver Gd. III
55. Osumanu Ahmed.....	Driver Gd. III
56. Daniel Doku.....	Driver Gd. III
57. Obodai Addison.....	Driver Gd. III
58. Charles Achia..... (Contract).....	Driver Gd. III
59. Fuseini Eyi-Mensah..... (Contract).....	Driver Gd. III
60. Basit Chentiwuni Yussif..... (Contract).....	Driver Gd. III
61. Eric Mensah..... (Contract).....	Driver Gd. III
62. Enoch Arhinful..... (Contract).....	Driver Gd. III
63. Stephen Atuahene..... (Contract).....	Driver Gd. III
64. Raymond Kwadwo Sefah..... (Contract).....	Driver Gd. III
65. Gideon Bissah..... (Contract).....	Driver Gd. III
66. Francis Amedzor..... (Contract).....	Driver Gd. III
67. Emmanuel Kofi Odoom..... (Contract).....	Driver Gd. III
68. Mike Kpanawor..... (Contract).....	Driver Gd. III
69. Amos Amoah..... (Contract).....	Driver Gd. III
70. Stephen Owusu Boateng..... (Contract).....	Driver Gd. III
71. Emmanuel Adu-Ansah.....	Driver Gd. III
72. Florence Allotey-Pappoe (Ms).....	Assistant Materials Officer I
73. Fati Musah (Ms).....	Assistant Materials Officer III
74. Rukayatu Abass (Ms).....	Assistant Materials Officer III
75. Justice Akwasi Acquah.....	Assistant Materials Officer III
76. Frank Osei Obeng.....	Assistant Materials Officer III
77. Patience Abra Amafoti (Mrs).....	Assistant Materials Officer III
78. Monica Amezah (Ms).....	Assistant Materials Officer III
79. Sarah Naa Doduwa Ashong Agyekum (Mrs).....	Assistant Materials Officer III
80. Caroline Darkoa (Ms).....	Assistant Materials Officer III

DEVELOPMENT SERVICES SUB-DIVISION

Department of Works

1. Saviour Sefakor Kpodo.....	Director
2. Fanny Appiawah Gyan (Ms).....	Deputy Director
3. Nicholas Kpakpo-Brown.....	Deputy Director
4. Peter Tusah.....	Deputy Director
5. Daniel Francis Owusu Dapaah.....	Assistant Director II
6. Francois Awedana Kwogana.....	Assistant Director III
7. Samuel Wason-Quaicou.....	Principal Technical Officer (Plumbing)
8. John Akurante.....	Principal Technical Officer (Carpentry)
9. Emmanuel Kwaku Kemevor.....	Principal Technical Officer (Masonry)
10. Abdul-Rashid Iddrisu.....	Senior Technical Officer
11. Christian Osei Bonsu.....	Senior Technical Officer (Carpentry)
12. Dauda Quao.....	Senior Technical Officer (Electrical)

Department of Estates Management

1.	Kwasi Asare Darko.....	Director
2.	Jonas Yengnibeh.....	Deputy Director
3.	Emmanuel Kudah.....	Deputy Director
4.	Mary Janice Bawah (Ms)	Assistant Director II
5.	Nana Kwesi Kumi Asante.....	Assistant Director IIA
6.	Emmanuel Nyame-Owusu.....	Assistant Director III
7.	Kwame Wahab Kwakye.....	Assistant Director III
8.	Emmanuel Ackon.....	Chief Technical Officer (Carpentry)
9.	Francis Kwasi Akorley.....	Chief Technical Officer (Plumbing)
10.	Sampson Appiah.....	Chief Technical Officer (Plumbing)
11.	John Kedzi.....	Principal Technical Officer
12.	David Nii Saka Allotey.....	Senior Technical Officer
13.	Prince Kabenla Quaidoo.....	Technical Officer (Electrical)
14.	Benedicta Nai (Ms)	Higher Executive Officer
15.	Frederick Gyebi-Donkor.....	Artisan III

Facilities Management Department

1.	Alexander Kofi Ediful (Dr)	Director
2.	Evelyn Agurgo Balfour (Ms)	Deputy Director
3.	Gilbert Amartei Armah.....	Deputy Director
4.	Andrews Tei Pinto.....	Deputy Director
5.	Akosua Agyeiwaa Twumasi (Ms)	Assistant Director IIA (Administration)
6.	Joseph Kwesi Moore.....	Assistant Director III (Facilities Management)
7.	James Amoah.....	Assistant Director III (Air-condition)
8.	Loretta Adjoa Mensah (Ms).....	Assistant Administrative Secretary IV
9.	Tahiru Sarbogu.....	Assistant Director III
10.	Louis Azaare (Dr).....	Assistant Director III
11.	Eric Stone Adjei.....	Chief Technical Officer (Air-condition)
12.	Divine Akpah.....	Chief Technical Officer (Electrical)
13.	Michael Lanquaye Lamptey.....	Chief Technical Officer (Electrical)
14.	Michael Aleh.....	Principal Technical Officer (Plumbing)
15.	Gershon Dehar.....	Senior Technical Officer (Air-condition)
16.	Peter Kodzo Kpo.....	Technical Assistant I (Plumbing)
17.	Noah Amponsah.....(Contract).....	Technical Assistant I (Electrical)
18.	Issaka Gariba.....	Chief Labourer
19.	Emmanuel Dodoo.....	Chief Labourer
20.	Moses Adjetey Adjei.....	Chief Labourer
21.	Stephen Adjei-Baffour.....	Chief Labourer
22.	Edward Ayurebome.....	Chief Labourer
23.	David Tetteh Ankamah.....	Chief Labourer
24.	Benjamin Appiah Nkansah.....	Chief Labourer
25.	Michael Dzamenu.....	Chief Cleaner
26.	Stella Boadi (Ms)	Chief Cleaner
27.	Theophilus Kwakye Ntow.....	Chief Gardener
28.	Helena Antwi (Ms)	Chief Cleaner
29.	Seth Obeng Ameyew.....	Chief Cleaner
30.	Emmanuel Annang Blebo.....	Chief Gardener
31.	Mutalib Mumin.....	Chief Labourer
32.	Maxwell Nii Saka Anege Akwei.....	Assistant Chief Cleaner
33.	Dominic Nketia.....	Technical Assistant III (Tiler)

34. Daniel Kwame Amekudzi.....	Technical Assistant III (Carpentry)
35. Kow Acquandah Wallace.....	Technical Assistant III
36. Daniel Asamoah Darko.....	Technical Assistant III (Painting)
37. Daniel Odoi Yemoh.....	Principal Gardener
38. Solomon Donkoh.....	Messenger
39. Gladys Zienaa (Ms).....	(Contract) Senior Cleaner
40. Evans Nii Ankamah Tettey.....	Senior Labourer
41. Grace Kwakyewah (Ms).....	Senior Cleaner
42. Joseph Kwapong.....	Labourer
43. Patrick Akologo.....	Labourer

PARLIAMENTARY SECURITY SERVICES DIVISION

1. Lt Col. Samuel Kofi Ofori (Rtd)	Senior Principal Marshal
2. Wg Cdre. Frederick Bawa (Rtd)	Principal Marshal
3. Laurretta Ntummy (Ms).....	Assistant Director IIA
4. Amatus Baataapoug.....	Assistant Director III
5. Ivy Naa Dedei Hammond (Ms)	Assistant Director III
6. Shiela Janet Noye (Ms)	Chief Administrative Assistant
7. Bright Tambo.....	Stenographer Secretary
8. Frederick Dodoo.....	Senior Executive Officer (Marshal)
9. Marian Serwah Kufuor (Ms).....	Executive Officer (Marshal)

Internal Security and Access Control Department

1. Grace Ntiriwah Duah (Ms).....	Assistant Internal Security Officer III
2. David Gyan.....	Assistant Marshal IV
3. Robert Mbawine Azaare.....	Security Officer
4. Kojo Adongo.....	Security Officer
5. Daniel Acheampong.....	Security Officer
6. James Baba Atinga.....	Security Officer
7. John Frimpong-Manso.....	Security Officer
8. Daniel Delali Horvey.....	Assistant Security Officer
9. Christopher Dogbey.....	Assistant Security Officer
10. Martin Nwinesonga Naah.....	Assistant Security Officer
11. Albert Tewone Benyimse.....	Assistant Security Officer
12. Amin Mohammed.....	Assistant Security Officer
13. Issah Safianu.....	Assistant Security Officer
14. Sarni Asigri (Ex. Sgt.).....	Principal Security Guard
15. Michael Asak.....	Principal Security Guard
16. Athanasius Walter Baaku.....	Principal Security Guard
17. Nelson Kwadzo Dey.....	Principal Security Guard
18. Alexander Adjei.....	Principal Security Guard
19. Charles Poribo.....	Principal Security Guard
20. Justine Owusu Babatu.....	Senior Security Guard I
21. Benjamin Boateng.....	Senior Security Guard I
22. David Darko.....	Senior Security Guard I
23. Benedict Wineyeya Dindago Asigri.....	Senior Security Guard I
24. Gabriel Atutra.....	Senior Security Guard I
25. William Anim.....	Senior Security Guard I
26. Kingsford Aidoo.....	Senior Security Guard I

27. Abudu Rahiman Sia.....	Senior Security Guard I
28. Patrick Sevor.....	Senior Security Guard II
29. Osuman Atinga.....	Senior Security Guard II
30. Henry Kpakpo Adotey.....	Senior Security Guard II
31. Francis Kaku.....	Senior Security Guard II
32. Jibrail Adnan.....	Senior Security Guard II
33. Byron Akuffo.....	Senior Security Guard II
34. Evans Avor.....	Senior Security Guard II
35. Ebenezer Duah.....	Senior Security Guard II
36. Peter Keney Adoteye.....	Senior Security Guard II
37. Russel Karikari Owusu.....	Senior Security Guard II
38. Eric Wiafe.....	Senior Security Guard II
39. Emmanuel Nana Mensah.....	Senior Security Guard II
40. Mohammed Mudassir Adjorlolo.....	Senior Security Guard II
41. Abukari Issahaku.....	Senior Security Guard II
42. George Mensah Nyarko.....	Senior Security Guard II
43. Abigail Debrah Dankwah (Ms).....	Senior Security Guard II
44. Freda Oppong (Ms).....	Security Guard
45. Ibrahim Shamwuna.....	Security Guard
46. Ametus Konbanpuo.....	Security Guard
47. Henry Jebuni.....	Security Guard
48. Silas Addai.....	Security Guard
49. Eric Kofi Mensah.....	Security Guard
50. David Tigapius Dinga.....	Assistant Security Guard
51. Deborah Nyantakyiwaa.....	Assistant Security Guard
52. JustLord Acheampong.....	Assistant Security Guard
53. Stephen Angaachaab.....	Assistant Security Guard
54. Elijah Baffoe.....	Assistant Security Guard
55. Elliot Badateri Freko.....	Assistant Security Guard
56. Bernard Essilfie Obeng.....	Assistant Security Guard
57. Victoria Sarpong.....	Assistant Security Guard
58. Emmanuel Ohene Baah Kissi.....	Assistant Security Guard
59. Solomon Ayamga.....	Assistant Security Guard
60. Gifty Mensah.....	Assistant Security Guard
61. Sheena Kakie Akrofi.....	Assistant Security Guard
62. Dennis Wekem Wongyega.....	Assistant Security Guard
63. Cedrick Nicholas Djadja.....	Assistant Security Guard
64. Obed Owusu Amoako.....	Assistant Security Guard
65. Anita Edmundson.....	Assistant Security Guard
66. Patrick Naa Kondiezine.....	Assistant Security Guard
67. Clement Asamoah.....	Assistant Security Guard
68. Richard Vuunibe.....	Assistant Security Guard
69. Yvonne Osei Suma.....	Assistant Security Guard
70. Gordon Somfo.....	Assistant Security Guard
71. Richard Ofei Dodoo.....	Assistant Security Guard
72. Denis Ofosu Asare.....	Assistant Security Guard
73. Yaw Acquah.....	Assistant Security Guard
74. Grace Serwaa Adjei.....	Assistant Security Guard
75. Ezekiel Nii Teiko Tagoe.....	Assistant Security Guard
76. Martin Alu.....	Assistant Security Guard
77. Samuel Obour Yeboah.....	Assistant Security Guard
78. Gilbert Nkansah.....	Assistant Security Guard
79. Michael Yaw Agyapong.....	Assistant Security Guard

80. Alhassan Kangyeingmena	Assistant Security Guard
81. Benjamin Kafui Gyamfi	Assistant Security Guard
82. Ibrahim Azaare	Assistant Security Guard
83. Nathaniel Danso Asare	Assistant Security Guard
84. Kaasuma Philip	Assistant Security Guard
85. Abdulai Angbanmwine Abu	Assistant Security Guard
86. Desmond Faanuzagla	Assistant Security Guard
87. Shadrach Puree Ngmenengsoa	Assistant Security Guard
88. Sampson Baazor	Assistant Security Guard
89. Ebenezer Kongwei	Assistant Security Guard
90. Bernard Awayiwu	Assistant Security Guard
91. Abubakari Kunkuni	Assistant Security Guard
92. Frank Ashitey Shaibu	Assistant Security Guard
93. Barnabas Angnamwine	Assistant Security Guard
94. Solomon Debrah	Assistant Security Guard
95. Andrew Agyekum	Assistant Security Guard
96. Godfred Nana Yirenkyi Nwiah	Assistant Security Guard
97. Eliasu Ibrahim	Assistant Security Guard
98. Latifa Umar Abdul	Assistant Security Guard
99. Alfred Bediako	Assistant Security Guard
100. Solomon Asumah	Assistant Security Guard
101. Michael Baba Atinga	Assistant Security Guard
102. Dakura Evarist Lai	Assistant Security Guard
103. Richard Kwesi Amofa	Assistant Security Guard
104. Albert Domanaa	Assistant Security Guard
105. Fuseina Osumanu Atinga	Assistant Security Guard
106. Maxwell Tambro	Assistant Security Guard
107. Innocent Gbormittah	Assistant Security Guard
108. Abigail Quarshie	Assistant Security Guard
109. Austin Kofodu	Assistant Security Guard
110. Christiana Kog Kontounku	Assistant Security Guard
111. Sharif Nurudeen	Assistant Security Guard
112. Godfred Makol Kidiyar	Assistant Security Guard
113. Abu Sahanuni	Assistant Security Guard
114. Vincent Amanortey Gidimadzor	Assistant Security Guard
115. Leticia Samwine	Assistant Security Guard
116. David Dankyi Abrokwah	Assistant Security Guard
117. Philip Patakro Asiamah	Assistant Security Guard
118. Muhammed Amin Salam	Assistant Security Guard
119. Philip Tampulima	Assistant Security Guard

Ushers Unit

1. Joseph Kwakye	Chief Usher
2. Anthony Gator	Chief Usher
3. Sampson Kaba Kwotuah	Chief Usher
4. Maxwell Tetteh	Chief Usher
5. Dennis Tetteh	Chief Usher
6. Charlotte Sarfo (Ms)	Usher Gd. I
7. Michael Akuamoah Boateng	Usher Gd. I

FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT SERVICES

FINANCE & BUDGET SUB-DIVISION

1. Daniel Tamkibe Chirawura.....*Coordinating Director*
2. Vida Afi Rose Tulasi (Ms).....*Chief Administrative Assistant*

Department of Finance

1. Lisa Mambora Tia (Ms)*Deputy Director*
2. Linda Agyemang Prempeh (Mrs).....*Deputy Director*
3. Richard Azumbil Kpelimnyanba*Finance Officer*
4. David Kyetong Guun.....*Assistant Finance Officer II*
5. Rex Bagbin.....*Assistant Finance Officer III*
6. Naana Smith Boyan (Mrs)*Assistant Finance Officer III*
7. Derrick Kwabena Boateng.....*Assistant Finance Officer III*
8. Bless Cudjoe (Ms).....*Assistant Finance Officer III*
9. Anita Somiah (Ms).....*Assistant Finance Officer III*
10. Mary Abena Yeboah (Mrs).....*Assistant Director III*
11. Gifty Amuaki Amoatey (Ms).....*Assistant Finance Officer III*
12. Derrick Papa Yaw Owusu-Mensah.....*Assistant Finance Officer III*
13. Hayford Bekoe.....*Principal Executive Officer*
14. Harry Armah.....*Principal Executive Officer*

Department of Budget

1. William Kafui Assem, Esq. (Dr).....*Director*
2. Esther Afia Amoah (Mrs).....*Assistant Budget Officer I*
3. Ugget Adjoa Kapuochieneh (Ms)*Assistant Finance Officer III*
4. Vishnu Osmond Buckle*Assistant Finance Officer III*
5. Emmanuel Asare.....*Assistant Director III*
6. Dorothy Gaisie (Ms)*Private Secretary*
7. Eugenia Nyamekye Quarshie (Ms).....*Senior Executive Officer*

COMPENSATION, BENEFITS & PENSIONS, ACCOUNTING & PROCUREMENT SERVICES SUB-DIVISION

- Karim Kuuri..*Coordinating Director*

Compensation, Benefits & Pensions Department

1. Albert Essuman.....*Deputy Director*
2. Richard Omenako Ansah.....*Compensation & Pension Officer*
3. Doris Dede Sika (Ms)*Assistant Compensation & Pension Officer I*
4. Kennedy Felasong.....*Assistant Compensation & Pension Officer I*
5. Herman Nana Osei Oppong Kyekyeku.....*Assistant Compensation & Pension Officer III*
6. Nana Yaw Adjei Adzinyo.....*Assistant Compensation & Pension Officer III*
7. Emma Nyantakiwaa Addei (Ms).....*Assistant Compensation & Pension Officer III*
8. Joy Agyepong (Ms).....*Assistant Compensation & Pension Officer III*

Accounting Department

1. Alfred Agbesi Kpodzro.....Deputy Director
2. Priscilla Amuakwa-Mensah (Ms).....Accountant
3. Nasirudeen Adam Baduon.....Assistant Accounting Officer I
4. Jason Akotus.....Assistant Accounting Officer I
5. Elvis Poku Osei.....Assistant Accounting Officer III
6. Mark Agambire.....Assistant Accounting Officer III
7. Isaac Kwesi Glover.....Assistant Accounting Officer III
8. Nicholas Arthur.....Assistant Accounting Officer III
9. Salim Suhuyini Yussif.....Assistant Accounting Officer III
10. Gideon Kabutey Taffah.....Assistant Accounting Officer III
11. Patience Bagbin (Ms).....Principal Accounts Officer
12. Jennifer Atwiwaa Atsiako (Ms).....Senior Accounts Officer
13. Caleb Castro Dzeagu.....Senior Accounts Officer
14. Priscilla Adjeiwaa Appiah (Ms).....Senior Accounts Officer
15. Bernard Oheneba Karkari Addaie..Executive Officer

Procurement Department

1. Mohammed Nsiah... (Contract).....Director
2. Abdallah Adam Ahmed... ..Deputy Director
3. Ebenezer Koomson.....Assistant Procurement Officer I
4. Jeremiah Acquah Adjei.....Assistant Procurement Officer II
5. Josephine Selorm Goka (Ms).....Assistant Procurement Officer III
6. Ivy Ama Ewoenam Agbeke (Ms).....Assistant Procurement Officer III
7. Benedicta Betty Abbey (Ms).....Senior Procurement Assistant
8. Simon Peter AcquahSenior Procurement Assistant
9. Amanda Laryea (Ms)Stenographer
10. Frank Somiah Andoh.....Executive Officer
11. Emmanuel Ankomah.....Clerical Officer

INFORMATION MANAGEMENT SERVICES

Rosemary Arthur-Sarkodie (Mrs) Deputy Clerk

IMS Secretariat

1. Collins Asare..... Assistant Director III (Administration)
2. Fusena Amirra Bashiru (Ms)Assistant Director III (Administration)

PARLIAMENTARY RESEARCH CENTRE

1. Mohammed Hardi Nyagsi... ..Coordinating Director
2. Abraham Ibn Zackariah (Dr).....Principal Research Officer
3. Judy Benedicta Aikins (Ms)Principal Research Officer
4. Cephas Egbefome... ..Principal Research Officer
5. Sandra Awuah (Ms)Senior Research Officer

6. Lord Michael Walierzumeh Baatuolkuu...	Senior Research Officer
7. Kwame Boamah-Gyau...	Senior Research Officer
8. Adjoa Abrefa-Tawiah (Ms)	Assistant Research Officer I
9. Blessed Henry Insaidoo...	Assistant Research Officer I
10. Philip Marvin Coleman.	Assistant Research Officer I
11. Abubakari Sadick Mohammed, PhD.	Assistant Research Officer I
12. Samuel Dukpo...	Assistant Research Officer I
13. Abdulai Muftaw.	Assistant Research Officer I
14. Ama Kesewaa Kwegyir Aggrey (Mrs)	Assistant Research Officer I
15. Elizane Yaa Sika Adams (Mrs)	Assistant Research Officer I
16. Sandra Kuffour (Ms)	Assistant Research Officer I
17. Abigail Adei Kotey (Ms)	Assistant Research Officer I
18. Alfred Benjamin Baiden...	Assistant Director 11B
19. Kelvin Bondzie..	Assistant Research Officer III
20. Matilda Ofori Anto Kachire (Ms)	Assistant Research Officer III
21. Nicholas Asubonteng...	Assistant Research Officer III
22. Kojo Anokye-Kwatutu Ocran..	Assistant Research Officer III
23. Gawsu Inusah.....	Assistant Research Officer III
24. Abdul-Basit Abdulai	Assistant Research Officer III
25. Ruth Angviele Gaayuoni (Ms)	Assistant Research Officer III
26. Priscilla Amanokor Ashong (Ms)	Assistant Research Officer III
27. Priscilla Adjei Poku (Ms)	Stenographer Secretary

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4. Clyde Henry Hyde...	Assistant Data Management Officer III
5. Bernice Ama Dziedzorm Nuworsu (Ms)	Assistant Data Management Officer III
6. Akosua Affumwaa Mensah (Ms)	Assistant Data Management Officer III
7. Noel Kobla Hlordze.....	Clerical Officer

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3. Emmanuel Odai Laryea.	Deputy Librarian
4. Emmanuel Nkansah Sefa.	Deputy Librarian
5. Amanda Delali Fie (Ms)	Deputy Librarian
6. Jemima Deles Yeboah (Ms).	Senior Assistant Librarian
7. Edith Boaduwa Anto (Ms)	Assistant Director IIA
8. Esther Esinam Degboe (Ms)	Assistant Librarian III
9. Ruth Opoku Adusei (Ms)	Assistant Librarian III
10. Michael Adjei Ablorh.....	Assistant Librarian III
11. Dora Asaba Cudjoe (Ms)	Assistant Librarian III
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13. Antoinette Kanubala (Ms)	Executive Officer (Administration)
14. Richard Kojo Boadi.....	Clerical Officer (Administration)

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2. Abdulai Issahaku Alhassan.Deputy Director
3. JohnBosco Aristotle Kanpogning Ansuura, (Dr) Ing.....Deputy Director
4. Daniel Mensah...Deputy Director
5. Ernest Taanu Berrick.. Deputy Director
6. Maxwell Kwadjo Anyah..Deputy Director
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8. Justice Ananabouh Yaro..Senior ICT Officer
9. Francis Kobina Essien..Senior ICT Officer
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11. Benjamin Abakah...Assistant ICT Officer I
12. Francis Adzayao.Assistant ICT Officer I
13. Issahaku Mohammed Mubarik..Assistant ICT Officer I
14. Samuel Lamptey.Assistant ICT Officer I
15. Felix Nii Aryeetey Armah...Assistant ICT Officer I
16. Frederick Dongbee Yendaw....Assistant ICT Officer I
17. Jastice Kofy Kafui Odikro...Assistant ICT Officer II
18. Kenneth Apodolla...Assistant ICT Officer III
19. Mahami Sualisu.Assistant ICT Officer III
20. Theophilus Kudjo Lumor.Assistant ICT Officer III
21. Emmanuel Odei Kwakye.Assistant ICT Officer III
22. Eric Yankah.Assistant ICT Officer III
23. Fred Agyepong...Assistant ICT Officer III
24. Fladys Tawiah (Ms)Assistant ICT Officer III
25. Samuel Kyeremeh...Assistant ICT Officer III
26. Seyram Akusika Dey (Ms)Assistant ICT Officer III
27. Kelvin Kwamina Bandoh...Assistant ICT Officer III
28. Roger Abendiba...Assistant ICT Officer III
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30. Mathias Korbi Ketorsugbor...Principal Technical Officer
31. Mark Nii Osa Mensah.....Principal Technical Officer
32. Sellasie Ameyibor...Principal Technical Officer
33. Frederick Yao Adzimahe...Technical Officer
34. Jacob Annertey Abbey..ICT Technician I
35. Kevin Nii Sackey Sackey.ICT Technician
36. David Darko-Mensah.Technical Officer
37. Roland Livingstone.Technical Officer
38. Bright Amlasi..Clerical Officer
39. Leopold Pinto..Clerical Officer

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2. Pamela Aba Woode (Ms)Deputy Director
3. Kenneth Kofi Asamoah.....Deputy Director
4. Jude Laryea Ako-Nai...Deputy Director

5. Linda Wendy Wordie (Ms)	Senior Publishing Officer
6. Francisca Gyasi Osei (Ms)	Senior Publishing Officer
7. Mariam Muntaka (Ms)	Assistant Director IIA
8. Millicent Akosua Birago (Ms)	Publishing Officer
9. Suraj Osman-Rasheed	Asst. Publishing Officer (Proofreading)
10. David Seyram Gadzekpo	Publishing Officer I
11. Justice Kese Opoku	Assistant Publishing Officer III
12. Linda Darley Ayikoe Edo (Mrs)	Assistant Publishing Officer III
13. Georgina Opoku Asare (Mrs)	Assistant Publishing Officer III
14. Theresa Ama Donkor (Ms)	Assistant Publishing Officer III
15. Samuel Darko	Assistant Publishing Officer III
16. Irene Sakyiwa Owusu (Ms)	Private Secretary
17. Samuel Abrefa	Chief Printer
18. Mary Lena Gharthey (Ms)	Chief Usher
19. Edwin Anyetei Ayeng	Chief Administrative Assistant
20. Victor Adenyo	Chief Printer
21. Moses Addey	Assistant Chief Printer
22. Gilbert Setsoafia	Principal Executive Officer
23. Daniel Aryee	Senior Publishing Assistant
24. Gifty Abia Salakpi (Ms)	Senior Publishing Assistant
25. Isaac Wesley Divine Azumah	Senior Executive Officer
26. Nicholas Timothy Clerk	Publishing Assistant I

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3. Thelma Anim Agyei (Ms)	Stenographer Secretary

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2. Peter Azameti Bamfo	Deputy Director
3. Ekuba Bobolo Quayenortey (Mrs)	Assistant Director I
4. Peace Abena F. Agbetsivi (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
5. Adwoa Odum Yankson (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
6. Randy Sackey	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
7. Julius Kwadwo Owusu Duah	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
8. Derrick Tsekpo	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
9. Matthew Amachie	Assistant Director III
10. Georgina Afia Kwarteng (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
11. Clement Gyetteh Sam	Public Relations Officer (Sign Language Interpreter)
12. Efua Buduwa Taylor (Ms)	Public Relations Officer (Sign Language Interpreter)
13. Georgina Joemerley Tagoe (Ms)	Public Relations Officer (Sign Language Interpreter)
14. Stephen Ampofo	Chief Technical Officer (Audio-visual)
15. Ibrahim Ansah	(Contract) Chief Technical Officer (Audio-visual)
16. Lemuel Godson Amamoo	Chief Technical Officer (Audio-visual)
17. Joseph K. D. Ocansey	Assistant Chief Technical Officer (Audio-visual)
18. Daniel Danso Amponsah	Assistant Chief Technical Officer (Audio-visual)
19. Godfred Nii Nikoi Kotey	Assistant Chief Technical Officer (Audio-visual)
20. Augustine Mumuni Bukari	Technician II

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6. Bridget Quao (Ms)	Public Affairs Officer
7. Ruby Odoflorkor Ocquaye (Ms)	Public Affairs Officer
8. Ewurasi Otuwaa Wobil (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
9. Enock Adomah.	Assistant Director III
10. Karimu Seidu Bogobiri.	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
11. Richella Akweley Addo (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
12. Melissa Yaa Serwaah Duah (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
13. Courage Toukuman Abdulai...	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
14. Matilda Danquah (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
15. Domina Dedo Mate-Kole (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
16. Lady Asomaniwaa Sakyi (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
17. Faustina Mensah (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
18. Rebecca Christiana Hutchful (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
19. Anita Lawerh Ocansey (Ms)	Stenographer Secretary

Department of Media Relations

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3. Sonnomma Abdul-Aziz Kaayora...	Senior Public Affairs Officer
4. Sulemana Sadat Alhassan.	Senior Public Affairs Officer
5. Nana Agyeman Birikorang...	Public Affairs Officer
6. Patricia Agyarewaa Boateng (Ms)	Assistant Director III
7. Simon Kanubala Andrah.	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
8. Bernard Kotey Hammond...	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
9. Yesmeen Abubakar Tetteh...	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
10. Abigail Lily Dotse (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
11. Nana Adwoa Abrefi Gyamoh (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
12. Edward Nana Afriyie Glover...	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
13. Gloria Borley (Ms)	Stenographer Secretary
14. Jubal Edinam Gadzekpo...	Clerical Officer

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2. Ibrahim Abu-Agyeman...	Assistant Director IIA
3. Mavis Ama Adjei (Ms)	Assistant Director IIA
4. Ruby Naa-Dei Ghansah (Mrs)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
5. Sarah Akuvi Ahumah (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
6. Rita Adu-Oppong (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
7. Salomey Mawuli Abor (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
8. Bless Ruth Adjetey (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
9. Doris Yemoley Mensah (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
10. Rahmatu Abdulai (Ms)	Senior Executive Officer
11. Maria Agbenu-Ntow (Ms)	Chief Telephonist/Receptionist
12. Esther Mingle (Ms)	Assistant Chief Telephonist/Receptionist

13. Millicent Dede Opatá (Ms)	Assistant Chief Telephonist/Receptionist
14. Esther Adda (Ms)	Assistant Chief Telephonist/Receptionist
15. Elizabeth Kutorwu (Ms)	Assistant Chief Telephonist/Receptionist
16. Bernice Asabea Asante (Ms)	Assistant Chief Telephonist/Receptionist
17. Francisca Tuffour (Ms)	Assistant Chief Telephonist/Receptionist
18. Gifty Atoo (Ms)	Assistant Chief Telephonist/Receptionist
19. Nathaniel Songojage	Clerical Officer
20. Edem Atinaval Appekey (Ms)	Clerical Officer

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2. Kweku Owusu-Asare (Dr)	Physician Specialist
3. Edna Abigail Thompson (Dr)	Principal Medical Officer
4. Rahinatu Ibrahim (Dr)	Medical Officer
5. Doreen Adu Danquah (Dr)	Principal Pharmacist
6. Haleemah Maame Esi Pavis-Djre	Senior Nursing Officer
7. Sedem Adamaley	Nursing Officer
8. Mercy Yaa Boatemaa Appiah	Nursing Officer
9. Priscilla Ansomah Osae	Staff Nurse
10. Rosemond Quainoo	Principal Enrolled Nurse
11. Juliana Messan	Deputy Chief Accountant
12. Hope Agbodzakey	Principal Biomedical Scientist
13. Suwebatu Seidu	Stenographer Secretary
14. Maudlina Sanka	Principal Biostatistics Assistant
15. Sadia Haruna	Dental Surgeon Technician
16. Ernestina Ablordeppey	Asst. Chief Technical Officer (X – RAY)
17. Maame Efua Egyima Annan	Registered Dietician

NATIONAL AMBULANCE SERVICE STAFF

1. Gifty Ohenewah Asante	Advance Emergency Medical Technician
2. Zakaria Tahiru Principal	Emergency Medical Technician
3. Douglas Aninakwah	Principal Emergency Medical Technician
4. Ebenezer Yeboah Senior	Emergency Medical Technician
5. Doris Quarshie	Senior Emergency Medical Technician
6. Cobby Obuobi	Senior Emergency Medical Technician

Parliamentary Protection Unit

1. C/SUPT John Awini Afuugu	12. C/INSPR Michael Osei Boateng
2. SUPT Tenkuu Simon	13. C/INSPR Sulemana Yakubu
3. ASP Charles Djan	14. C/INSPR Prince Kodua Kesse
4. ASP Joyce Afi Ofori	15. C/INSPR Emmanuel Gbedemah
5. ASP Maurice A. Surikuye	16. C/INSPR David K. Nsuban
6. C/INSPR Alexander Aboagye	17. C/INSPR Daniel Kitcher
7. C/INSPR Benjamin Kudjo	18. C/INSPR Sekyi Bernard Adu
8. C/INSPR Charles Dente	19. C/INSPR Iddrisu Mohammed
9. C/INSPR Jonathan K. Klutse	20. C/INSPR James K. Dumson
10. C/INSPR Kwabena Fosu	21. C/INSPR John Doe Sorkpor
11. C/INSPR Mamudu Ali John	

Parliament Fire Unit

1. DOII Victus Dzakpasu
2. DOIII Daniel Asamoah
3. DOIII Benedicta Bassaw
4. ADOI Nathaniel Nartey
5. ADOI Stella Barnor
6. ADOI Benoni Teye
7. ADOI Grace Enyonam Adjoo Dakeku
8. ADOII Jeffrey Ampiah
9. ADOII Moses Tarley
10. ADOII Felix Asare
11. STNOI Francis Nyanku
12. STNOI Justice Ofori
13. GOII Nketia Comfort
14. ASTNO Bannerman Alfred
15. ASTNO Charles Kabutey

THE PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

IN THE FIRST MEETING OF THE SECOND SESSION OF THE NINTH
PARLIAMENT OF THE FOURTH REPUBLIC OF GHANA
WHICH OPENED ON 3RD FEBRUARY, 2026 IN THE THIRTY-FOURTH YEAR
OF THE FOURTH REPUBLIC

FOURTH SERIES SECOND VOLUME OF SESSION VOLUME 131

THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

FIRST MEETING, 2026

Tuesday, 3rd February, 2026

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 3:00 p.m.*

[THE SPEAKER, RT HON ALBAN
SUMANA KINGSFORD BAGBIN, IN
THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

The Speaker: Hon Members, let us
recite the National Pledge.

[NATIONAL PLEDGE]

The Speaker: Hon Members, on the
Order Paper we need to take the item
numbered 7, which is the Business
Statement for the first week. We need to
adopt that before we can go on with the

Business on today's *Order Paper*. The
Business Statement for the first week —
The Chairperson of the Business
Committee would present the Report for
and on behalf of the Committee.

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE

**Chairperson of the Business
Committee/Majority Leader (Mr
Mahama Ayariga):** Mr Speaker, the
Committee met today, Tuesday, 3rd
February, 2026 and arranged Business of
the House for the first week ending
Friday, 6th February, 2026.

Mr Speaker, the Committee accordingly
submits its report as follows:

Arrangement of Business

Formal Communications by the Speaker

Mr Speaker, you may read any
available communication to the House.

Statements

Mr Speaker, pursuant to Order 91(2), Ministers of State may be permitted to make Statements on Government policy. You may also admit Statements by Hon Members in accordance with Order 93.

Bills, Papers and Reports

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 159, Bills may be presented to the House for First Reading. However, those of urgent nature may be taken through the various stages in a day in accordance with Order 160.

Pursuant to Order 97, Papers may be laid during the week and reports from Committees may also be presented to the House for consideration.

Motions and Resolutions

Mr Speaker, Motions may be debated and their consequential Resolutions, if any, taken during the week.

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee takes the opportunity to welcome all Hon Members back from the recess.

The First Meeting is expected to be short and demanding of Hon Members. The House will be honoured to host H. E. the President to deliver to the House a Message on the State of the Nation. In this regard, a significant part of the Meeting will be dedicated to the debate on the Message and consideration of

other Business before adjournment *sine die* for the Easter break.

Hon Members are, therefore, entreated to brace themselves for the Meeting.

Referrals at Committee

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee, cognisant of the number of referrals pending before Committees, urges all Committees to prioritise consideration of the referrals and promptly report to the House during the Meeting in accordance with Order 267 (4).

Conclusion

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 216 (2) and subject to Order 67, the Committee submits to the House the order in which the Business of the House shall be taken during the week.

Tuesday, 3rd February, 2026

Roll Call

National Pledge

Statements

Presentation of Papers

- a. Report of the Auditor-General on the Statements of Foreign Exchange Receipts and Payments of the Bank of Ghana (BoG) for the Half-Year Ended 30th June 2025.

- b. Medium-Term National Development Policy Framework (2025-2029).
- c. The Coordinated Programme of Economic and Social Development Policies (2025 – 2029).
- d. Ghana National Action Plan on Business and Human Right.
- e. Report of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs on the Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025.
- f. Report of the Committee on Security and Intelligence on the Security and Intelligence Agencies Bill, 2025.

Presentation of Instruments

- Education Regulatory Bodies (National Teaching Council) Regulations, 2026.

Motions

This House adopts the Report of the Ad-Hoc Committee to consider the establishment of a Pension Scheme for Members of Parliament.

Second Reading of Bills

- Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025.

- Security and Intelligence Agencies Bill, 2025.

Private Members' Motions

(#) That this Honourable House, pursuant to Article 103 of the 1992 Constitution and Orders 204, 212, 213, 262 and 263 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, established an Ad-Hoc Committee to investigate the Gold-for-Reserves Scheme, including its design, implementation, governance, financial performance, environmental and public health implications, and any related matters.

Committee Sittings

- Joint Caucus Meeting

Wednesday, 4th February, 2026

Roll Call

Statements

Presentation of Papers

- (a) Report of the Parliamentary Delegation on the 150th Inter Parliamentary Union Assembly held in Tashkent, Uzbekistan.
- (b) Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on a familiarisation visit to Six

(6) Independent Constitutional Bodies.

(c) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Right to Information Commission for the Year 2024.

Motions

- That this Honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the Budget Performance Report in respect of the National Commission for Civic Education for the Period January to December, 2024.

Committee Sittings

Thursday, 5th February, 2026

Roll Call

Statements

Presentation of Papers

Motions

- That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the Budget Performance Report in respect of Office of the Electoral Commission for the Period January to December, 2024.

Consideration Stage

- Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025

- Security and Intelligence Agencies Bill, 2025.

Committee Sittings

Friday, 6th February, 2026

Roll Call

Statements

Presentation of Papers

Motions

Committee Sittings

Mr Speaker, thank you.

3:10 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the Business Statement has been presented. We may want to hear from Hon Members if there are comments to make.

Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): Mr Speaker, I see a good attempt to ensure that we reduce our carbon footprint. The *Order Paper* today is rather displayed on the console. I want to commend the Table Office and urge them to sustain this effort.

Mr Speaker, a few observations, the Hon Majority Leader spoke to the

outstanding Questions that we have. In fact, he did not elucidate that we have over 300 Questions that are pending. In the face of the fact that this is a short Meeting, we have to design a clinical approach as an attempt to dispense with these Questions since we have a maximum of eight weeks. I see my good Friend, the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources smiling, which is an indication that he will be coming to answer all his Questions. That is just by the way. So, 300 Questions within eight weeks, appears as a tall order. So, Table Office, we will need some innovation on how we can deal with these Questions.

Mr Speaker, we on this Side of the House have been patient. During the last Meeting, a number of critical Questions were not answered because as at the time we had decided to dispense with these Questions in whole, then we had the Budget Statement and Estimates being considered. So, we all compromised in the spirit of ensuring that we were able to dispense with Business. So, Majority Leader, we must insist on these Questions. On a lighter note, at the Business Committee today, he said that we could approach it through a winnowing. Obviously, he said it on a lighter note, the Orders do not allow that. So, the Questions will have to be answered. How do we deal with it?

Mr Speaker, instances where the sector Ministers cannot appear, the deputies must be made to come and answer these Questions. So, the writing of letters to say that the Ministers are out

of jurisdiction or are unavoidably absent, must end. Within these eight weeks, let us get clerical, let us get effective, and let us deal with these over 300 Questions that are outstanding. Hon Richard Acheampong is staring at me. He is the Second Deputy Majority Whip; he should make sure the Ministers come. If they cannot come, the deputies must be here.

Mr Speaker, during the last Meeting, we had a number of Bills. For want of a better expression, we were rushing a number of the Bills. Majority Chief Whip, as we know ahead of time, that we have eight weeks, if we are going to have extended Sittings, let us factor it *ab initio*. So that we do not wait five days to adjournment then decide to have extended Sitting and we end up punishing ourselves unnecessarily. So, let us pay attention to that. Where we think that extended Sitting would be relevant, let us consider it and factor it *ab initio*. So, these will be my observations.

I see the Motions that had been pending for some time have all been advertised. We hope we will go by this Business Statement. If for any reason, any Question has to be changed or days scheduled for Questions have to be changed, we need to be given a prior notification and Leadership needs to be engaged. I can bear with the Majority Leader. Not one Question has been advertised for the first week, meanwhile, we knew ahead of time that a number of these Questions are still pending.

I do not know how the Hon Majority Leader can justify that for the entire week, not even one Minister is being scheduled to come and take these Questions. Because of the number of Questions we have outstanding, I want to suggest strongly to the Leader that even though this is the Business Statement which we are going to adopt largely, let us look at the possibility of getting — The Minister for Roads and Highways is available; he has a number of Questions. He is always present, unlike other Ministers. The Minister for Energy and Green Transition is also not like others. He is always present. There are Questions that were advertised in the name of the Minister for Energy and Green Transition and the Minister for Roads and Highways; they are ready to answer them so why are they not put here?

Mr Speaker, we have been charitable enough. These Questions must find a section in the Business Statement, then we can hold them to it and make sure that the Ministers come here and do justice by answering these Questions.

Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think the Hon Minority Chief Whip was at the Business Committee meeting and indeed we discussed all the issues that he has repeated here. I have given him every assurance that we are going to engage the Ministers and ensure that as much as possible we are able to have them in the

House to answer as many Questions as possible. In addition, at the Business Committee meeting, I did indicate that we will engage your good self, Mr Speaker, and your Deputies so that we can have some understanding regarding Questions that will allow supplementary, how long Questions should last, how long Answers should last and how many Questions each Member should be allowed to ask in every Meeting. So that we can manage the time very efficiently. So, all those were discussed at the Business Committee meeting.

Mr Speaker, also, we urged the various Committee Chairpersons to whom Bills have been referred to make sure that they report to this House early enough for us to take those Bills through Consideration Stage and not to wait until the dying days of a Meeting. Then they will put pressure on Hon Colleagues to have to stay late into the night to work on those Bills.

So, we would be pushing the various Chairpersons to work on Bills referred to them expeditiously and bring it back to this House. I have started insisting and demanding that all Chairpersons who had Bills pending before we went on recess, must immediately bring their Reports at least for us to debate and then we take the Bills through the Consideration Stage. That is the only way that we can ensure that some Bills are not taken in the dying days of a Meeting and then we all have to sit here till late in the night. I can assure you that all Ministers who have to be in this House are punctual and that they attend.

Sometimes, the reason we do not see the Ministers is that they sometimes come here waiting for us to start. I know, for instance, the Minister for Finance was here around 12 noon. He sat and waited. We only started after three hours and so he had to leave and it is the same with a lot of Ministers. So let us also try to be punctual.

3:20 p.m.

The Speaker was ready. The reason he did not start Sitting was because our Friends opposite decided that they would go and visit the new flagbearer at a time when this House is supposed to be Sitting, and after they have done that, then they come and raise issues about the time that we start proceedings.

So, Mr Speaker, let us all keep to the time. When we know that we have Sitting starting at 2 p.m., let us all be here at 2 p.m. We can start, withdraw, and then go and do other things, and when we are needed, we will be called back into the Chamber. Because we are live on television and we have our own television station, Ghanaians are watching. So, when we tell them that we are starting at 12 noon, they start watching out to see if we will be there at 12 noon. So, when we delay, it does not speak well of us as their Leaders. So, if they want us to be punctual and to have all the agenda that we have set for ourselves achieved, then we must make sure we are in the Chamber at the right time.

I believe I have responded to all the issues that the Hon Minority Chief Whip has raised. I believe the Hon Minority Leader has no issue to raise.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the issue of time management is key, and we are going to stick to that this Meeting and thereafter. So, I will take it that the Statement as presented is adopted —

Yes, Hon Minority Leader?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, I have one issue, but I was signaling the Hon Majority Leader that our Colleague, Professor Nyarko, was on his feet. So, I wondered if you would so recognise him.

The Speaker: I recognised you because of the invitation to treat by the Hon Majority Leader.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, he wants to start an early fight —

The Speaker: So, if you want to add any other thing, I will not accept that.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: No, I am saying that I was signaling him.

The Speaker: So, you have nothing to say?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I do.

The Speaker: Then say it.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, before him? That is fine.

Mr Speaker, with respect, we have an important matter which has been pending for several months.

Mr Speaker, you may recall that the Chief of Staff, through a letter, directed that state agencies should terminate the employment of Ghanaian youth who were employed after the 2024 Elections.

Mr Speaker, we, the Minority, became aware with evidence that there were some excesses. Excesses in the sense that, though the letter was specific that those who were recruited after the 2024 Elections, Ghanaian youth who had been employed as far back as 2017 were all dismissed from their lawful employment.

Mr Speaker, the Minority filed a Motion. The Motion was admitted by you. The Hon Majority Leader raised a preliminary objection, which objection was upheld by the Hon First Deputy Speaker. We subsequently filed a Motion for review under the rules of this House, which you admitted. This Motion was moved by my good self, seconded by my respected Colleague from Ofoase Ayirebi, and the Chief Whip from the Majority Side, Hon Etse Dafeamepkor, started a debate for his Side. Mr Speaker, the promise made by the Chair was that the following Tuesday, the debate will continue so that you could eventually

rule on the matter. Unfortunately, because it was a matter that you were the only one to preside, and because of some other intervening matters, we have not been able to take this Motion, much as we kept prompting the Hon Majority Leader to take steps to allow this to be done. Several times the Motion appeared on the *Order Paper* but we could not take it.

Mr Speaker, this is a matter that affects the livelihood of Ghanaians. Per the information we had, we have in excess of 15,000 Ghanaian youth affected by this directive, and they are still at home. In fact, the last time the Minister for Employment and Labour Relations was on the Floor, he said that he had also received some petitions, and he had called for some investigations to be done, and he will revert to us, but that does not stop the House from enquiring into the matter, just for the sake of good governance.

Mr Speaker, these Ghanaian youths are sitting at home together with their wives and their extended families and for over a year now, they have received no justice. Mr Speaker, I would humbly plead with the Hon Leader of Government Business to endeavour to include the Motion in this Report. I raised this at the Business Committee, and of course I must be fair to him and the understanding was that we would have to engage you so that you give us time to hear, since you are the only person who can preside over this particular motion. So that you give your

ruling for a Committee to be set up to investigate this matter, so that the people out there who have been affected by this directive will know that the representatives of the people, Parliament, cares about their interests, and are always willing to take steps. It is almost a year. We are in February, and the directive came in March 2025. It is far too long.

So, Mr Speaker, that is my very humble prayer on this rising.

The Speaker: Hon Members, on this matter, I direct that as Chairman of the Business Committee, not the Leader of Government Business, but as Chairman of the Business Committee, you call this matter to be relisted and scheduled for consideration of the House. This thing has gone on since the inception of the Fourth Republic. Anytime there is a change of government, we have people's appointments being terminated. In many cases unlawfully, and they are not even paid. I remember as Minority Leader in 2001, all the staff of National Mobilisation were dropped; nothing was paid. Some directors were dismissed, and some even went to the High Court, rulings were given, and the government did not abide by the rulings.

3:30 p.m.

The lawyers struggled and they could not enforce them. The same happened again in 2009, and continued up to date. We cannot keep on this way. We have to improve. So, each Parliament has

decided to give some guidance as to the way forward. I think it is a good Motion that we should create the opportunity for Parliament to have a say. So please, take this directive as urgent, and make sure that this Motion is re-listed for the consideration of the House. With this, I just want to inform Hon Members that we have—

Hon Majority Leader? Time management.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, he has not given the full facts. The objection that was raised in this House was based on the fact that the matter was pending in court. That was the objection that was raised. The First Deputy Speaker ruled that to the extent that somebody had gone to seek constitutional enforcement of the rights of those people, it would not be appropriate for us, as a Parliament, to enquire into the matter. That was the objection. Mr Speaker, these are the facts based on which the objection was taken.

The First Deputy Speaker ruled based on those facts. If he wants us to re-list and debate it, we will re-list and debate it. You will consider the debate in addition to the basis on which the First Deputy Speaker upheld my objection, and then the Speaker will take a decision. We have no problem and we are ready. Except that when one of the parties has gone to court and the matter is in court, and then they say that Parliament should enquire into the same matter, and I said it will prejudice the outcome. Our rules are clear on that. So, why do we not wait

for them to litigate the matter in court and let us know the outcome.

The Hon Member is talking about some 200 or 300—who are they? Has he brought their list? When he filed the Motion, did he attach their names? Does he have specific people, organisations, *et cetera*? He should not just get up and say things without any evidence. Yes, some people who were dismissed raised issues, but the law is there. If they feel they were unfairly dismissed, they can go to court. I know somebody in this Chamber who was touting the Hon Members of the National Democratic Congress (NDC), saying that he will see if the NDC will be able to use ‘protocol’ to recruit their party members into the agencies. He was boasting about how they had done that using ‘protocol’ to populate all the agencies with their party boys and they were waiting to see how the NDC is going to do that. [*Uproar*]

This was public; it was not private. The videos are all over. This is how some of those people got into the agencies; they did not get their own merit. Procedures were not complied with and there was no fairness. This is what happened. I recall that I was a member of the Transition Committee. At the Transition Committee meeting, we raised the issue—

The Speaker: Hon Majority Leader, please, I have heard you. We would rather take your first point. As for the second one, you are just speaking in favour of what I said. It is something that

we need to look into and then guide future Governments.

But the Majority Leader raised a first preliminary issue that the decision and directive of the First Deputy Speaker was based on the rules of the House. Hon First Deputy Speaker, will you confirm this before I can come to the Hon Minority Leader?

Mr First Deputy Speaker (Mr Bernard Ahiafor): Mr Speaker, it is very true that I based my decision on the fact that the matter was pending in court. Mr Speaker, one of us, in the person of Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah, took the matter to the Supreme Court. At the time that the application was made, his case was pending before the Supreme Court so to constitute a Committee to investigate, while the matter is pending squarely before the Supreme Court, will offend our rules. Mr Speaker, on the basis of that, I ruled in giving the appropriate directives.

The Speaker: Hon Ekow Assafuah or Hon Minority Leader, is the case still in court?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, this is a House of rules. The Hon Majority Leader through the submissions he made, is trying to throw dust into our eyes. The ruling of the First Deputy Speaker was challenged under Standing Order 127. We attached the ruling and stated the full facts of the case and filed this before the Speaker. What the issue is, is simply that the

Speaker admitted the grounds of our appeal and admitted our Motion for review. In fact, we have actually moved our review application. I moved the review application and the Hon Member for Ofoase Ayirebi seconded the review application. Hon Dafeamekpor started the debate and had a 25-minute submission at the Despatch Box—his boss was not there—on their Side.

Mr Speaker, all we are saying is that, let us continue the debate. All that he was saying was that there was a ruling—we have moved past that. If a body of first instance makes a determination, and a plaintiff in that matter is dissatisfied, and appeals it, and a higher authority upholds the grounds of appeal, and opens the case up, we do not go back and say that there was a ruling. We have moved past that. We have moved the Motion, it has been seconded, and the Majority, submitted strong points in opposing our application. What the Speaker is saying is that, let us re-list it, because the Motion has been pending. We need to continue the debate, then he makes a determination. That is what the Speaker is saying. But where they are taking us back to is just to confuse everybody. We have moved past that.

Again, our Friends on the other Side, are not coming from a principled angle. The same argument, the Minority relied on the First Deputy Speaker's ruling in the matter of Justice Gertrude Araba Esaaba Torkornoo. When the nomination came before this House, our argument was that, for the time being, the

ruling which was the precedence in this House was his ruling, is, if a matter is pending, before court, to avoid any injustice, this House must stay its hands. This is what he said. Now, at the time, My Lord Justice Baffoe-Bonnie was nominated, there were pending cases by Justice Torkornoo.

Mr Ahiafor — *rose* —

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Secondly, the issues that—*[Interruption]*—Can you be tolerant? The issues that My Lord Justice Torkornoo was pursuing had to do with her employment. We felt that by allowing the vetting, it would have adverse effects on the case before the court, especially so, when my Lord Justice Baffoe-Bonnie was the one to ensure the empanelling.

The Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, please, let me listen to the First Deputy Speaker. He is on his feet.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, is he on a point of order?

The Speaker: I do not know. Let us listen to him first.

Mr Ahiafor: Mr Speaker, before delivering my ruling, based on the fact that Hon Assafuah had taken the matter before the Supreme Court, I was furnished with a copy of the court process. In the case of Torkornoo that he is referring to before the Appointments Committee, I had no process of the court before me, attesting to the fact that this

matter is pending before court. So, the two issues are quite different.

3:40 p.m.

I made my ruling based on the fact that in raising the objection, the process of the court was furnished. If we look at the relief being sought at the Supreme Court, there is no way by which those reliefs will be pending before the Supreme Court, yet Parliament will be delving into the matter. So, I used the principle of *sub judice* to make my ruling.

Mr Speaker, when we speak in public, we do not uphold grounds of appeal; we uphold appeals or dismiss the appeals, so there is nothing like upholding grounds of appeal. I based my ruling on the process that was put before me.

The Speaker: Hon Members, please, let us go back and refresh our memories. When you get the facts right, this House is always there for you to come back to discuss this matter. In the meantime, we have to proceed with the Business of the day, because we are raising so many things, and now we are clouding the initial issue that was raised, which I give the directive on. So, let us refresh our memory, because it has been a long time, and I think that some of you are not getting the facts right. The public is listening to us, and they are getting more confused. I am getting confused myself —[*Laughter*] So, I have to go and read the *Hansard*, because many of you are not fond of speaking the truth.

Well, one of the things I hate in life is to tell lies. I am being truthful and factual. We can audit the *Hansard*, and you can see that I am on all fours on this matter, please. When you want to raise the issue, you say it is politics as if politics is about speaking untruths. So please, let us go and refresh our memory on this matter.

In the meantime, the Business Statement as presented is adopted.

We have before us some students from some educational institutions visiting us, I believe, for the first time. We have students from the University of Cape Coast. These are students studying International Relations. They are being led by one of their lecturers by the name of Dr Solomon Sika-Bright. Sika? Am I right? Is it Sika? Sika, I think, is about money, and he is also called Bright. They definitely are coming from Cape Coast North and they are 66 in number. Hon Members, you can see them just directly opposite me at the Public Gallery.

Minority Leader, I think Winneba is closer to Cape Coast. Do you not want to acknowledge the presence of students from the University? On your behalf, I want to welcome them and wish them a fruitful visit to the House. We have our staff that are ready to take you through some of the preliminaries of parliamentary work. So, you are welcome, and particularly the fact that you are studying International Relations, we now have an Office of Parliamentary Relations and Diplomacy. You may ask

and get some guidance from them as to what we do in that direction. Please, you may resume your seats.

We have also students from Seventh Day Adventist (S.D.A.) Senior High School. They are 64 in number and they are from Sunyani East Constituency. They are led by the senior housemaster, Mr Abraham Owusu. You are also warmly welcome. Take time to learn a few things before you go back. Sunyani is quite far, so make use of your presence here so that the investment that was made in bringing you here will not go waste. You are welcome.

[Students of the University of Cape Coast were acknowledged]

[Students of SDA Senior High School were acknowledged]

The Speaker: Hon Members, let us move on to the next item. I want to welcome you before I can open the floodgates for you to have these harmonious exchanges. So, I will read a short Statement to welcome all of you to this Meeting.

FORMAL COMMUNICATION BY THE SPEAKER

Welcome Address

The Speaker: Hon Members, I warmly welcome you to the First Meeting of the Second Session of the Ninth Parliament of the Fourth Republic of Ghana, which formally commences

today, Tuesday, 3rd February, 2026, and scheduled to recess on 27th March, 2026. The House, and indeed the nation, remains deeply grateful to Almighty God for the guidance, protection, and special grace He bestowed upon us. It is God, and nothing else, who enabled us to successfully conclude the First Session of the Ninth Parliament.

By his providence, we are gathered here today, one year into the life of the Ninth Parliament, with renewed sense of purpose and commitment to serve our dear nation and its people. Hon Members, it is my hope that the recess afforded you the opportunity to receive feedback from our people, reflect, and to replenish your capabilities for the strenuous and focused Business of this Second Session of the Ninth Parliament.

Hon Members, during the First Session, Parliament made steady progress in the discharge of its constitutional mandate. Notable among our achievements were the orientation of new Members, the constitution and operationalisation of the Committees of the House, and the consideration and passage of Bills, constitutional and statutory instruments, as well as other essential parliamentary Business. These accomplishments reflect the collective efforts of Hon Members, parliamentary Leadership, Committees, officers of the Parliamentary Service, and Civil Society Organisations. I want to take this opportunity to commend the Leadership, all Members and staff, for your dedication and hard work.

Notwithstanding these achievements, we must also acknowledge with candour the challenges we encountered during the period under review.

3:50 p.m.

The First Session tested us in many important ways. It tested our endurance and adherence to parliamentary discipline, our tolerance for different views and our collective commitment to the traditions, customs and conventions that sustain the democratic culture of Parliament.

These trying moments invite us to reflect not merely on events, but on the standards we set for ourselves as custodians of the people's mandate. It is through such reflection that institutions learn lessons, mature and become stronger. Accordingly, I wish to inform the House that the Speakership, together with the Leadership of the House, is planning to observe the first anniversary of the Ninth Parliament.

This event will provide an opportunity for deeper introspection into the operations, conduct, and the lived experiences of the First Session of the Ninth Parliament, with a view to distilling lessons to guide the work and conduct of Business during the Second Session. The date for this observance and the detailed programme outline will be communicated to Hon Members and the public in due course. Let me underline that this occasion will be institutionalised at the commencement of

each Session to serve as a means of taking stock of the conduct and performance of Parliament during the preceding Session and to enable us to take measures to guard proceedings in the Session that follows.

The past year was also marked by moments of deep sorrow and grief for the entire nation. This House was affected. The House lost three distinguished Colleagues: Hon Ibrahim Murtala Muhammed, Member of Parliament for Tamale Central; Hon Ernest Yaw Kumi, Member of Parliament for Akwatia, and, very recently, Hon Naser Toure Mahama, Member of Parliament for Ayawaso East. The earlier ones, we observed a minute's silence; today, I will allow a Statement to be made to give us the opportunity to do the same for the latest, that is, Hon Naser Toure Mahama.

In the meantime, with your kind permission, may their souls rest in perfect peace in the bosom of the Almighty God. The passing of these patriots is a solemn reminder of the fragility of life and the sacrifices inherent in public service. Their departure, therefore, calls upon us to uphold compassion, solidarity, mutual support, and love for one another, even as we engage in robust debates to make our lives in this world a better experience. While differences of opinion are natural in every democratic Parliament, respect for one another, love, and unity of purpose must always hold sway over hatred and bitter partisanship.

Hon Members, the Second Session, and particularly this Meeting, presents us with a demanding legislative and oversight agenda. By the provisions of Order 47 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Clerk to Parliament is enjoined to send to each Member a copy of the agenda of the Meeting.

This Meeting offers us a renewed opportunity to strengthen cooperation, build consensus on matters of national importance, restore and sustain public trust and confidence in Parliament through disciplined, transparent and accountable conduct. It is my hope that Hon Members will rise above partisanship when circumstances require us to do so. We should uphold the dignity of this House and work collectively to advance national development and improve the lives of our people.

With these words, I wish all Members a peaceful, productive and purposeful deliberation during this Meeting. We have a blessed Parliament and a blessed country; let us cherish and preserve them. I thank you all for your attention. *[Hear! Hear!]*

I will now give the opportunity to your Leaders to also say a few words of welcome to all of you, starting with the Minority Leader.

OPENING REMARKS

Minority Leader (Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin): Mr Speaker, my dear Colleagues, this

afternoon we reconvene in this honourable House to confront uncommon challenges facing our Republic. At home, our people struggle for employment; abroad, Ghana's voice faints as traditional friends turn their back on us. In such times, Parliament must recall its purpose. We sit not for comfort, but to serve a nation's worry with unmet promise.

Mr Speaker, before we turn to the nation's business, let me pause, just as you did, to mourn our Colleague, Hon Naser Toure Mahama, Member of Parliament for Ayawaso East. Now, to his grieving family, constituents, and the National Democratic Congress (NDC) and every Member of this august House, I extend deepest condolences on behalf of the Minority Caucus. May his soul rest in perfect peace.

Mr Speaker, on our part, the Minority, our party's delegates have spoken. Through vibrant democracy, our party has chosen His Excellency Dr Mahamudu Bawumia to lead us into the future. *[Hear! Hear!]*

4:00 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I am happy to say that this morning, the Caucus extended warmest congratulations to the flagbearer and we promised to work with him, and stand shoulder to shoulder with him to deliver on his vision for our party and for our country come December 2028 elections. Indeed, our conversation with him has energised us. We spoke as family about

the formidable task ahead, earning the trust of Ghanaians and returning to power to rebuild and restore Ghana under Dr Bawumia's presidency. Let me take this opportunity to say to the distinguished sons of our party, Hon Kennedy Ohene Agyapong, Hon Dr Bryan Acheampong, Hon Dr Yaw Osei Adutwum and Ing Kwabena Agyei Agyapong, we offer a brotherly salute. The contest is over, collaboration begins.

Mr Speaker, we as Minority are clear that the unity that demands our work in this very Chamber requires us to be rigorous. It simply means that the collective good of our country and party must be the overriding objective. We also thank the National Democratic Congress (NDC) for the statement they issued acknowledging the peaceful election we held. Our flagbearer's first great task and ours start this very hour. The journey to begin 2028 begins with the very first step we take together right now.

Mr Speaker, Ghana is crying out for bold, competent, proven leadership. The current Administration, in our view, is failing to manage our economy with transformation in mind, failing to inspire confidence, failing to uphold the dignity of our people. But our duty as Minority is not merely to critique. The New Patriotic Party (NPP) is not just a political option; it is the singular solution Ghana requires. The records will bear us out. We showed that for eight years under former President Kufuor and under former President Akufo-Addo's

leadership, we led Ghana towards transformation until Covid-19 struck. Against all odds, we put Ghana back on the path of recovery. Indeed, the NDC offers much more Public Relations (PR) gimmick than proper management. The NPP offers a proven blueprint. History will ask what we did when Ghana needed us most. The solution is here, and the solution is us.

Mr Speaker, it is also with profound joy that we welcome back to this House, our Hon Colleague, Hon Matthew Nyindam, Member of Parliament for Kpandai, to his rightful place. *[Hear! Hear!]* The Supreme Court has spoken with constitutional authority, validating his election and restoring justice. This is a resounding triumph for democracy itself. We hail the justices for their courage in the face of brazen attempt to stampede them into politically expedient miscarriage of justice. This House has urged institutional restraint, as we did with the bogus processes that, in our view, forced the former Chief Justice, Justice Araba Esaaba Torkornoo, out of office. But our Colleagues opposite chose to speed up the process, which we again opposed. Mr Speaker, let this be our pledge: we shall model maturity, eschewing hasty suspensions that invite chaos. In restraint lies our strength. In haste, our humiliation.

Outside this Chamber, the story is harsher. A nation without two important Ministers. It has been months since the tragic helicopter crash took the lives of our Ministers for Defence, and

Environment, Science and Technology. Those vital ministries remain without substantive leadership. We demand forthwith that Mr President nominate persons to man these ministries. It is not enough to have the Minister for Finance with a huge responsibility also taking up the Ministry of Defence.

Mr Speaker, on jobs, last November, six young women died in a stampede at El-Wak Sports Stadium during a recruitment process. When a country turns a recruitment gate into a graveyard, it is a government that has failed our youth. On food, farmers complain of losses while families struggle with high prices, when food rot in villages, while children sleep hungry in towns. The problem is policy and logistics. Meanwhile, Government says that inflation has come down. Our farmers have always carried Ghana on their shoulders with respect to food security in the country. Unfortunately, in 2025, farmers were faced with lack of agricultural inputs. Fertilisers, certified seeds, and agricultural machinery distributed to farmers were woefully inadequate.

The Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, I have to move to another meeting, so the First Deputy Speaker will take the Chair.

4:04 p.m. — [HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER, MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE CHAIR]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, you may proceed.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I will take it again. Our farmers have always carried Ghana on their shoulders with respect to food security in the country. Unfortunately, in 2025, farmers were faced with lack of agricultural inputs. Fertilisers, certified seeds, and agricultural machinery distributed to farmers were woefully inadequate. The food glut challenge we witnessed in 2025 must also be properly addressed. We expect the Government to ensure that adequate warehouses are provided and that all warehouses that were started by the previous administration are completed in good time. Again, our cocoa farmers are crying for payment. We hereby urge the Ministry of Food and Agriculture and the Ministry of Finance to take steps to ensure that our hard-working cocoa farmers are paid for all the supplies that they make to Cocoa Board.

Mr Speaker, in our country today, gold has turned to ghosts. The hardship is not accidental. It is the consequence of choices, including those that threaten our collective wealth as a nation. During the recess, not one but two distinct gold scandals rocked the very foundations of our economy, revealing a pattern of staggering incompetence and catastrophic failure. First, we confronted the missing millions. The International Monetary Fund (IMF) published a report and flagged US\$214 million losses through the third quarter of 2025 from the Gold for Reserves Programme. These

were not hypothetical risks. These were realised losses, lost to trading shortfalls and questionable fees. This sum is not an abstraction. It is classrooms never built, hospital equipment never procured, farm input never graded. It is the future of our nation sacrificed on the altar of opaque and reckless financial engineering.

But this situation did not end with the missing money. It escalated into vanishing gold itself. Official Bank of Ghana data confirms a collapse so severe that it defies belief. Our gold reserves, which stood at 37.1 tonnes in September 2025, plunged by nearly 50 per cent to mere 18.6 tonnes by December 2025. In just three months, we witnessed the utter evaporation of prior gains, a financial phantom event that has left our national balance sheet dangerously exposed. The connection between these two catastrophes is not incidental. It is a causal and speaks to a profound moral failure.

4:10 p.m.

On one hand, this Government has proven utterly incompetent in combating the scourge of illegal mining. The prevention and fight against *galamsey* have been abandoned. It has allowed *galamsey* to flourish unchecked, devastating our forests, poisoning our rivers, and destroying the livelihood of our farmers. And for what purpose? The evidence suggests a desperate, cynical strategy to source gold from these very destructive channels in a frantic bid to

prop up Ghana's cedi through these reserve programmes.

Mr Speaker, we, the Minority, state without equivocation that this is a policy of national self-sabotage. I repeat, the gold reserve policy that the Government has introduced, to the extent that the Government is not taking steps to ensure full enforcement of anti-*galamsey* operations, we say for the record that it is a policy of national self-sabotage. We are monetising the destruction of our environment and the theft of our future to feed failing financial schemes. And as the data now proves, that scheme itself has backfired catastrophically. The gold bought at such a great cost to our environment has seemingly vanished, and the money allocated to secure it has evaporated. When gold is turned to ghosts, the ghost that haunts the poor is hunger. When reserves disappear in millions, and they vanish, and we are told that they are rather diversifying, the trust of the people dissolves into dust.

Therefore, Mr Speaker, this House has a solemn and non-negotiable duty. We must insist on full, transparent, and immediate accounting. And we thank the Rt Hon Speaker for admitting the Motion by the Minority to get into this matter. We must demand answers to the questions the nation is asking: Who designed this flawed programme? Who authorised the pricing and the fee structure that led to such losses? Who

profited from these transactions? And ultimately, who bears responsibility for this double disaster of missing millions and vanishing gold? But as a Minority, we have some solutions for the Government. If, indeed, the Government believes that this is a policy worth considering, then it must provide the cost of enforcing this policy, and this must come to Parliament for the people's representatives to interrogate it.

If Parliament does not have the courage to follow the gold, trace every transaction and demand every document, then we would have lost far more than the money. We would have surrendered our moral compass and betrayed the sacred trust placed in us by the people of Ghana.

Mr Speaker, as we are at the mismanagement in the country and at home, the world changes without us. The United States announced an indefinite pause in immigrant visa processing for Ghanaians. The message is unmistakable. Ghana has slipped from trusted partner to flagged concern. Our foreign policy, the inconsistency thereto, and the adversarial posture have replaced professional diplomacy with domestic theatre. When our Ministry of Foreign Affairs treats international partners as props for local politics, ordinary Ghanaians become collateral damage. The ultimate answer is not simply to lobby foreign embassies. It is to build a

Ghana worth staying in. A serious nation does not treat its people as exports.

Mr Speaker, reports show a worrying spike in assaults on journalists. A state that cannot protect the pen will soon find it cannot protect the ballot box. Attacks make headlines, then files gather dust while impunity gains confidence. Violence against journalists is an attack on Parliament itself, because it is the media that carries our debate to the people we represent.

Mr Speaker, the Minority in this Meeting shall pursue vigorous accountability; it will not just be a slogan. It is going to be our schedule. The Minority would formally move for targeted parliamentary enquiries on the following: the helicopter disaster, the El-Wak tragedy, the gold reserve losses, the violence against journalists, the abuse associated with bail conditions by certain investigative agencies of state, the U.S. visa ban, and, not least, the unlawful dismissal of Ghanaian youth. We will not accept indefinite delay. Accountability without a calendar is merely public relations.

Mr Speaker, the Ghanaian people are tired. They are tired of the speeches and rhetoric of the ruling Government. They want their standard of living to improve. They are concerned about utility prices. Electricity tariffs have shot up by 27 per cent under this Government. To my

Colleagues in the Majority, the Minority will be firm, but we are ready to be fair. Opposition is not to sabotage. We will demand quality in terms of governance. And to my Colleagues in the Minority, our strength is in the seriousness we bring to debate. Nations are not rescued by miracles. They are rescued by choices. The choices we make in this Meeting will echo in the homes of the jobless, in the hearts of the grieving, and in the verdicts of history. Let us rise to the occasion and demonstrate that we are formidable and that we are not just opposing, but we also offer solutions.

Mr Speaker, let me, on this note, thank Colleagues and welcome them back to this Chamber and wish all of us a successful deliberation. Thank you so much. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I will accordingly proceed to give the floor to the Majority Leader for his opening remarks.

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, I rise to welcome back from recess, Colleagues who have converged here to carry out a critical constitutional function.

Before I proceed, let me join my Colleague, the Minority Leader, to express the sincerest condolences to all of us on the loss of our Colleague, Hon Naser Toure Mahama, the former

Member of Parliament for Ayawaso East in the Greater Accra Region. Our Colleague was fully with us in the last Meeting and during recess, we unfortunately lost him. May his soul rest in perfect peace.

Mr Speaker, let me again join my Colleague to congratulate the New Patriotic Party (NPP) for organising internal primaries that produced a flagbearer. I congratulate the former Vice President, Dr Mahamudu Bawumia, on his victory.

4:20 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I have listened to my Colleague, the Minority Leader. I just want to indicate that I paid attention to the results from his Constituency—*[Laughter]* Hon Kennedy Agyapong got 644 votes and Dr Mahamudu Bawumia got only 79 votes—*[Interruption]*—in the Constituency of the Minority Leader. Given his interest in enquiries, I think this is a matter we must look into—*[Laughter]*

Mr Speaker, this House reconvenes at a time when the Ghanaian economy has regained stability after a period of severe distress. I just listened to my Colleague, the Minority Leader, speak extensively about the Ghana Gold Board and the loss that is reported to have occurred.

Mr Speaker, what I hear and what is being reported, is that GHC2.4 billion equivalent to US\$214 million, may have

been lost. They are not asking the question of what has been gained. I am asking the question, what has been gained?

Mr Speaker, the statistics show that in 2024, gold from artisanal small-scale mining sold to the state was 63.6 tonnes. In 2025, as a result of the activities of the Ghana Gold Board, gold sold to the state from artisanal miners jumped to 103 tonnes—[*Hear! Hear!*]~~—~~from 63.6 tonnes to 103 tonnes; a jump of 39 tonnes.

Mr Speaker, the value of one tonne of gold is US\$96.5 million. So, 39 tonnes added by Ghana Gold Board gives us US\$3.8 billion. So, if we lost US\$214 million and gained US\$3.8 billion, they should do the mathematics. Why would this House waste its precious time interrogating and investigating such a gargantuan gain to the Republic of Ghana? Simple mathematics. This is simple mathematics and not Fufulso Primary School mathematics—[*Laughter*]

Mr Speaker, there is nothing to investigate. We should be commending the Ghana Gold Board Policy for the enormous gain that this Republic has made from the implementation of the Policy. When this Parliament commenced its mandate, the nation faced high inflation, unsustainable debt levels, eroded confidence and constrained fiscal space. The decisions before us were difficult but necessary.

Today, there is clear evidence that those decisions are yielding results. Inflation has fallen to single digits. Interest rates are easing. The national currency has stabilised and debt indicators are improving. These outcomes reflect disciplined policy choices, strong institutional coordination and importantly, the robust oversight, scrutiny and approval exercise by this House in fulfilment of our constitutional mandate.

Mr Speaker, Parliament is not an appendage of the Executive. We are an independent arm of government and trusted by the people of Ghana to approve, amend, reject and hold the Executive to account. In performing this duty, Parliament has acted in the national interest, balancing economic necessity with social responsibility and ensuring transparency, accountability and respect for democratic process.

Mr Speaker, as we begin this new Session, our task must now evolve; economic stabilisation, while necessary, is not sufficient. The responsibility before this House is to support legislation and policies that convert stability into growth, growth into jobs and jobs into improved living standards for our people.

Mr Speaker, this House must also reaffirm its commitment to constructive debates and cooperation. Differences of opinion enrich our democracy, but division must never obstruct national

progress. Ghanaians expect solutions, not stalemate.

Mr Speaker, it is also right that we acknowledge effective leadership when it delivers results. That is why I am here to once again commend President John Dramani Mahama and the National Democratic Congress (NDC), because they deserve commendation for the discipline, experience and clarity with which they have governed during a challenging period of our nation.

The progress recorded in restoring confidence, easing economic pressure and laying the foundations for sustainable growth reflects leadership that has prioritised the national interest. Allow me to present an overview of Ghana's fiscal and microeconomic performance in 2025, underscoring the key achievements and reforms that have strengthened our economy and laid a solid groundwork for 2026.

The fiscal deficit for 2025 was contained at 1.8 per cent of Gross Domestic Product (GDP), reflecting prudent fiscal management and improved revenue mobilisation. Total public debt decreased from US\$726.6 billion in 2024 to US\$630.2 billion in 2025; representing a 13.3 per cent reduction in just one year.

Debt as a share of GDP fell significantly from 68.7 per cent to 47.0 per cent, a reduction of 23.7 percentage point in just one year, strengthening the country's debt sustainability profile.

Real GDP growth remained steady at 4.8 per cent, supported by resilience in key sectors. Inflation remained stable at 8 per cent, aligning with the Bank of Ghana's targets. Value Added Tax (VAT) reforms announced in 2025 are in full implementation in 2026, aiming to ease the cost of doing business and supporting households.

4:30 p.m.

We removed and decoupled Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund) and National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA) levies from the VAT base, enabling input tax deductions and lowering business costs by 5 per cent. We abolished VAT on recognisance and prospecting of minerals, reduced the effective VAT rate from 21.9 per cent to 20 per cent, and increased the VAT registration threshold from 200,000 to 750,000.

Mr Speaker, we extended the VAT zero rating on locally manufactured textiles to 2028. We recapitalised Agricultural Development Bank (ADB) and Consolidated Bank of Ghana (CBG) with GHC1 billion, strengthening the financial sector, making it stable, supporting credit flows to households and businesses. For the first time since 2007 when the cedi was redenominated, the Ghanaian cedi appreciated by 32 per cent against the

United States dollar, marking a historic milestone and reflecting the resilience of our economy and the success of our stabilisation policies. The average lending rates have declined from 30 per cent to 22 per cent and Treasury Bill rates from 29 per cent to 11 per cent, making financing more affordable for businesses and households. These improvements have generated approximately GHC8 billion in national savings on interest, directly benefiting the private sector and citizens.

Mr Speaker, 2025 has been a year of fiscal consolidation, microeconomic stability and structural reform. These measures have positioned Ghana for sustainable growth in 2026, enhanced its sustainability, and improved its business and investment climate. Looking ahead, 2026 promises to be a transformative year for Ghana with targeted initiatives across all key sectors.

Mr Speaker, the Government will complete 30 abandoned E-blocks Community Day schools under GETFund. The Government will construct 200 new Junior High Schools, 200 new Primary Schools, 200 new Kindergartens, 400 Teacher Bungalows and 400 sanitation facilities. Funding will also be provided for textbooks,

school furniture and transport for learners. Six new regional hospitals will commence construction this year, alongside two district hospitals at Bole and Shama, while 10 Agenda 111 hospital projects will be completed. Ongoing projects at La General Hospital, Effia Nkwanta, Okomfo Anokye Maternity and the Ashanti Regional Hospital will continue, and diagnostic and treatment centres will be established across major hospitals through Public Private Partnerships (PPPs).

Mr Speaker, MahamaCares will receive GHC2.3 billion, and GHC9 billion is programmed for National Health Insurance Scheme (NHIS) claims. Essential medicines, vaccines and free primary health care will be ensured in the ensuing year. The Government would allocate GHC500 million for district housing, including resettlement of Akosombo Dam spillage victims.

Mr Speaker, a major push will also be made for critical infrastructure, including the long-awaited Accra-Kumasi Expressway. Additionally, GHC200 million is earmarked for mini stadia. The amount of GHC1.1 billion will support Livelihood Empowerment Against Poverty (LEAP), GHC401 million for women-owned Small and

Medium Enterprises (SMEs) through the Women's Development Bank, GH¢170 million for the National Apprenticeship Programme, GH¢169 million for Basic Education Certificate Examination (BECE) registration, GH¢474 million for nursing trainee allowances and GH¢292 million for free sanitary pads for girls. The National Theatre in Accra will be rehabilitated, and the second theatre will be developed in Kumasi. An amount of GH¢20 million will be seed for the Creative Arts Fund, and GH¢150 million will support anti-illegal mining operations, GH¢50 million is allocated for fishing nets and outboard motors. These initiatives collectively push 2026 as a year of tangible progress, improving education, health care, infrastructure, social protection and economic opportunities for all Ghanaians.

Let me also acknowledge the successful election of Dr Mahamudu Bawumia as flagbearer of the New Patriotic Party (NPP). We congratulate him and his party for concluding that internal democratic process.

Mr Speaker, if you observed, my friends on the other Side were all in white today to celebrate the victory. I joined them to wear white to celebrate the victory. The reason I have worn white to celebrate the victory is because the Bawumia that I know, the National

Democratic Congress (NDC) will beat him any time of the day. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Speaker, Ghanaians do not forget. This is not a new beginning; it is a repackaging of the same administration, the same economic ideas, and the same record that pushed this nation to the edge. We cannot rewrite recent history, and we cannot rebrand responsibility away. Ghanaians will judge not by new faces or fine words but by lived experience, credibility and results. They lived the experience of a Bawumia as a Vice-President, the credibility of the NPP and the Bawumia and the results of the Bawumia economic management.

Mr Speaker, the foundations of recovery have been laid. The responsibility before us now is to consolidate these gains and accelerate Ghana's journey towards sustainable growth and shared prosperity. We will be considering the following sector-related legislation. We will continue with the Ghana Cocoa Board Amendment Bill, the Ghana Investment Promotion Authority Bill, the Ghana Deposit Protection Amendment Bill, the Exemptions Amendment Bill, Income Tax Amendment Bill, and the Extractive Industries Fiscal Reforms Bill will all be taken.

Mr Speaker, we would also take the Rent Bill from the Ministry of Works and Housing, and the Parent Buffer Zones Regulations. We will also have legislation from the Ministry of Education to deal with the College of

Education, and then also to establish the Ghana Book Development Council. We will have the Environmental Protection Carbon Market Regulations 2026, the Basic Ionising Radiation Control Regulations, the Integrated Management Systems Regulations, the Emergency Preparedness and Response Regulations, the Design of Nuclear Installation Regulations, and the Review and Amendment of the Biosafety Act.

Mr Speaker, the Ministry of Energy will bring new legislative proposals for the Nuclear Power Corporation, which is the Nuclear Power Corporation Bill, the Renewable Energy Authority Bill, and then the Minister for Transport will also bring the Road Traffic Amendment Regulations to deal with the issues of discipline among *Okada* riders. The National Petroleum Authority (NPA) Act is also going to be revised. There will be a legislation on the Ghana Banking Services Agency Bill.

Mr Speaker, we will also have a new comprehensive revision of our Minerals and Mining Legislation in the form of a new Minerals and Mining Bill. The Ghana Geological Survey Authority Regulations, the Minerals and Mining Regulations, the Wildlife Resources Mining Regulations, the Survey Council Bill will all be presented to us.

Mr Speaker, the Ministry of Energy has a lot, including renegotiated power purchase agreements that will be brought to us for us to consider, and other major projects in the sector that will be required to approve as a Parliament. The Local Government will also bring the Local Governance University Bill, and then we will have a University for Local Governance and Development Bill. We will also have Bills from the Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy, and Religious Affairs to abolish the Coastal and Middle Belt Development Authorities, which we announced some time ago. They will also bring some amendments on the Land Use and Spatial Planning Act, and the Ministry of Sports and Recreation will bring regulations to actualise the new Sports Fund Act.

4:40 p.m.

There will be a Bill to establish the National Sports College, Winneba. There will be Regulations to enforce the Ghana Anti-Doping Act, 2024 (Act 1116) that was passed some time ago. The Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts will bring a legislation to elevate the Kwame Nkrumah Memorial Park to an Authority to ensure that this historic site is preserved and promoted with the dignity it deserves. We will also move to establish the Bureau of Ghana

Languages as an Authority, so a Bill to achieve that will also be brought.

Mr Speaker, we are gathered once again at a time of growing hope and tangible progress across our nation under the leadership of President John Dramani Mahama and his Government. We are witnessing a restoration of confidence in our institutions, in our economy and in our shared future. From the market trader to the teacher, the farmer to the student, there is a sense that Ghana is moving forward with purpose. Mr Speaker, it is obvious that our country is making progress and this Parliament is going to move forward in terms of approving legislation that will fast-track the progress that is being made. I urge Hon Colleagues that this Session is a short one; we have just about eight weeks. I plead with them, let us be punctual; let us sit in the Chamber; let all the Committees be up and doing; and let us work assiduously to accomplish assignments referred to us as Committees. All Committee Chairpersons should do well to deal with all the outstanding referrals. Let us ensure that within the eight weeks, we achieve as much as is humanly possible.

Mr Speaker, I cannot conclude without welcoming our friends among the press corps. We will not be able to succeed in this meeting without their support. We will also welcome the staff of the Parliamentary Service, many of whom,

even during the recess, sacrificed precious time to work with certain Committees, including the Public Accounts Committee, the Committee on Security and Intelligence, the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs and others. They were all busy working on Bills that were referred to them during the recess. I want to welcome all our staff who have always supported us to succeed as a Parliament and to assure them that we will work together and ensure that this Meeting is an action-packed Meeting, this Meeting is a successful Meeting and this Meeting achieves a lot for the people of Ghana. I thank you very much and I welcome all of you.

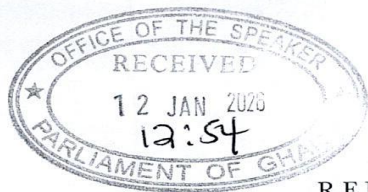
Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Hon Leaders. Yes, Minority Leader?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, my Hon Colleague, the Majority Leader forgot to welcome Hon Member for Kpandai back into the Chamber. I wanted to draw his attention.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, you are completely out of Order.

Hon Members, let us move to the item numbered 4, Message from His Excellency, the President of the Republic of Ghana.

COMMUNICATION FROM THE PRESIDENT
Absence from Ghana



REPUBLIC OF GHANA

Jubilee House

The President

8th January, 2026

Rt. Hon. Speaker,

ABSENCE FROM GHANA

In accordance with Article 59 of the 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, I write to formally notify you of my intention to travel to London, United Kingdom on Sunday, 11th January, 2026.

I am expected to return to Ghana on Friday, 23rd January, 2026.

In my absence, the Vice President, Professor Naana Jane Opoku-Agyemang, shall perform my functions in accordance with Article 60(8) of the Constitution.


JOHN DRAMANI MAHAMA

**THE RT. HON. SPEAKER
OFFICE OF PARLIAMENT
PARLIAMENT HOUSE
ACCRA**

*(2) Clerk/Usker
B.U. to be read
to the House.
12/1/26*

cc: The Vice President
Jubilee House
Accra

The Chief of Staff
Jubilee House
Accra

VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND THE OFFICIAL REPORT

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We then proceed to take the *Correction of Votes and Proceedings and the Official Report*.

Hon Members, I have in my hand the *Votes and Proceedings* of Friday, 19th December, 2025, for correction.

[No correction was made to the Votes and Proceedings of Friday, 19th December, 2025]

Hon Members, the *Official Report* of 18th December, 2025, under correction. Hon Members any correction?

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may I take the House to column 7, paragraph 1, line 5. The comment under my name, the sentence should be "... the outstanding matters that were raised ..." and not "...was raised..."

Again, under the same column 7, paragraph 4, line 5, the comment under my name must read, "the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs may do this on his behalf."

Mr Speaker, I believe that will be all. Thank you for the opportunity.

4:50 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much Hon Member. Any further correction? Thank you very much, Hon Member. Any further corrections? In the absence of any further corrections, the *Official Report* of

Thursday, 18th December, 2025 as corrected is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, let us move to Statements, the item numbered 8. I have a Statement, more or less a tribute, in memory of the late Hon Naser Toure Mahama, to be taken by Hon Jajah. You have the floor.

STATEMENT

Tribute to the Late Hon Naser Toure Mahama

Mr Yussif Issaka Jajah (NDC — Ayawaso North): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. With your leave I read the tribute Statement of the late Colleague of ours, Alhaji Naser Toure Mahama.

Mr Speaker, Alhaji Naser Toure Mahama was a distinguished businessman, political leader, devoted family man, and committed servant of the people of the Ayawaso East Constituency. His life was marked by excellence, humility, discipline, and unwavering dedication to public service. From the boardroom to Parliament, and from his Constituency to his home, he lived a life of purpose and impact, quietly shaping communities, institutions, and lived for decades.

Hon Toure hailed from Kue, a community in the Northern Region of Ghana, and was born on Wednesday, 17th March, 1965, in Nima 441. He was raised within the rich cultural and moral framework, Ghanaian values, hospitality, integrity, leadership, and communal

responsibility. These formative influences shaped the strong character that would later define his political and business leadership.

Hon Toure began his basic education at Kanda 1 and 2 Primary School, and later proceeded to West African Senior Secondary School (WASS) in Accra. With a strong desire to broaden his horizon, he travelled extensively to Syria, Jordan, and Japan, gaining valuable work experiences that shaped his worldview, discipline, and commitment to service. After years abroad, he returned to Ghana in the year 2000, and soon aligned with the developmental vision of the National Democratic Congress (NDC).

In the year 2006, he began active service in the party, earning the trust of members and community leaders through dedication, humility, and hard work. His unwavering commitment to the betterment of his people led to his election to Parliament in the year 2012. He entered into this House in the Sixth Parliament on 7th January, 2013, where he represented, with excellence, the good people of Ayawaso East. He was a devoted Muslim throughout his life, guided by the principle of faith, service, compassion, and humility.

Mr Speaker, Hon Naser Toure believed deeply in lifelong learning. Despite his early successes in business and leadership, he continued to invest in his education and professional development with academic institutions like London Centre of Management, Zone Investment Ghana, International

University of the United States, the Centre for Energy, Petroleum and Mineral Law and Policy (CEPMLP), in Boston, USA. These academic pursuits laid the foundation for his remarkable competence, particularly in the energy and petroleum sector, areas that later influenced significantly both in Parliament and in private enterprise.

Before and during his political career, Hon Naser Toure distinguished himself as an astute businessman. He was the Managing Director of the Aminaser Group of Companies, a thriving company. He nurtured it into a respected national brand. Under his stewardship, the group grew into a multifaceted business empire with a strong community impact. The major companies under the group include Aminaser Oil and Gas Company Limited, Aminaser Mart, Aminaser Construction, Aminaser Forex Bureau, and OTA Forex Bureau.

Hon Nassar Toure was more than a Managing Director, he was a visionary leader who held policy, empowered staff, created employment, supported young entrepreneurs, and demonstrated measurable excellence in Ghana's private sector landscape. His passion for community growth, fairness, and national development led him into politics. He became a dedicated member of the NDC, serving his party and constituency with passion and humility.

In 2012, he was elected as the Member of Parliament for Ayawaso East Constituency in Accra, a passion he held with honourable distinction for four

consecutive terms until his demise in January, 2026. Mr Speaker, during his tenure, Hon Toure Mahama served on a number of Committees, including the Committee on Energy, where he was the Vice-Chairman until he died; the Committee on Roads and Transportation as a Member; the House Committee; the Committee on Private Members' Bill and the Private Members' Motion; the Committee on Judiciary; and many others. Mr Speaker, he also served on several boards, including the Petroleum Commission and Energy Commission.

He was known among his Colleagues as a calm, respectful, principled, and thoughtful legislator; one who preferred service to noise and impact to popularity. His contributions to the Committee on Energy were particularly notable, reflecting his deep knowledge in the petroleum regulation, upstream negotiation, and energy sector management.

Hon Naser Toure served the people of Ayawaso East with extraordinary dedication. He was fatherly, approachable, generous, and available to all. He provided educational support and scholarship, offered job opportunities through his business, and immensely supported community organisations and youth groups. His constituents remember him for the following notable projects, infrastructure and sanitation improvements, roads and traffic upgrades, community facility enhancements, bridge and local links, sanitation and engagement focus, parliamentary roles and influence, health, and many others.

Mr Speaker, behind this public figure was a devoted family man. Hon Toure Mahama was married to his beloved wife, Hajia Amina Adam McNaza, for over 25 years. The home was one filled with love, mutual respect, and partnership. He was blessed with a son and a daughter, and one adopted daughter. As a father, he was caring, present, loving, and protective. His children remember him as their guide, teacher, provider, and a hero.

Hon Naser Toure fought his final illness with strength, dignity, and faith. Mr Speaker, on Saturday, 4th January, 2026, after a brief period of sickness, he passed away at the Korle-Bu Teaching Hospital.

5:00 p.m.

His transition marks the end of an era, but his legacy, values, and impact remain deeply entrenched in the hearts of his family, his constituency, his business community, and Colleagues in Parliament. Hon Naser Toure Mahama lived a life worth celebrating, a life of service, excellence, humility, and devotion to both God and humanity. He was a pillar of strength, a beacon of leadership, and a blessing to all who encountered him.

Mr Speaker, let me end this with two verses from the Qur'an chapter 20 verse 55 which says *minhaa khalaqnaakum wa fiyhaa nu'lydukum wa minhaa nukhrijukum taaratan ukhra* to wit, From the earth we created you and into the

earth we will return you and from it the earth we will extract you another day. Mr Speaker, permit me to quote the last verse coming from the Qur'an chapter 2 verse 156, which says *Inna lillahi wa inna ilayhi rajiun* to wit, Allah says indeed to him Allah we belong and to him shall we return.

Mr Speaker, with this, let me say may the Almighty Allah grant our Colleague, Hon Mahama Naser Toure Jannatul Firdaus. May the good Lord forgive his shortcomings, and may the good Lord bless his family and all who mourn him. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Statement ably made, it is now for comment. I give the Floor to Hon Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah.

Mr Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah (NDC — Ho West): Mr Speaker, I want to commend my Brother, the Deputy Minister for Tourism and Creative Arts, Hon Jajah, for this tribute on behalf of all of us and for our Hon Colleague, my immediate past Vice-Chairperson of the Committee on Energy. Mr Speaker, the late Hon Naser Toure Mahama met us in this House when in the Ninth Parliament, I was asked to Chair the Committee on Energy. He had been a Member of the Committee on Energy, the Vice-Chairperson and Deputy Ranking Member of that Committee. When I took over as the Chairperson of the Committee on Energy, with vast experience and knowledge in the energy

sector, both the petroleum and power sectors, I relied heavily on him.

Mr Speaker, in the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, I was asked to represent Parliament somewhere else, and he, as the Vice-Chairperson of the Committee, had to take over and perform his duty. Little did we know that that was the last official duty that he would be performing on this Floor.

Mr Speaker, just as my Colleague has mentioned, Hon Naser Toure Mahama was a calm personality. Anytime we go for a meeting, and we need some understanding, he is the one we rely on, being a Member of that Committee for four consecutive periods in the House. We have lost a gem. We have lost someone who has knowledge in the field of petroleum and power.

On Sunday 4th January, I was driving to church when I heard the news that my Vice-Chairperson has passed on. Quickly, I made two telephone calls and it was confirmed. I was really shocked because even though our Hon Colleague was not in the best of health, anytime we have Committee meetings, even outside, Hon Naser Toure Mahama would like to be at that Committee meeting. Sometimes at the peril of his own life, he travels with us. We see him travelling back to Accra and then returning to Committee meetings or even our rounds when we are visiting some installations under our Committee.

He was one person you will not find angry. Sometimes, at provocation from other Colleagues, he would just say “Hon Chairman, calm down. We have done this before, and we will do it again. Hon Chairman, calm down; do not mind them. We have done this before”. That is the person we have lost. We can only say may his soul rest in peace and we pray that his family will take solace in the fact that he has performed his duty and received a higher calling to perform that.

Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

Mr Matthew Nyindam — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Matthew Nyindam?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I am travelling out of town, and this is an important tribute that I want to really comment on, so if you give me the opportunity—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You have the floor.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Thank you.

Mr Speaker, it is unfortunate I have to make these comments at a time that my respected Brother is no more with us. But one thing I need to put across is that when we come into this Chamber with our party colours hanging around our neck, we must make friends across the aisle. Our Hon Colleague and I struck a

great accord when we entered into this Chamber together in 2013. We bonded. He will come home, and we will eat together. I will go to his house, and we will eat together. Hajia will cook and say “Leader, come and eat”.

Mr Speaker, the only time that Hon Naser will not answer my telephone call, especially when I became a Majority Leader, was when I found myself in crisis and I needed him. After operations, he will answer my telephone call and say “Leader, this one, forgive me” and I would say, I understand. Mr Speaker, he kept talking about his daughter, a very beautiful hard-working daughter, and I kept talking about my son. Little did we know that both kids were pursuing a medical programme, and the same prestigious university had admitted them for their medical education. As if it is a coincidence. Because he will come to me and say, Leader, your daughter wants to do medicine; she passed the IB, and I say, your son also made it, we are trying to get admission for him; he has gone through the interview.

Mr Speaker, it was only when we travelled out of town that we met, and there we were, the kids had met in the same university doing medicine. So, if I am unable to visit and Hajia gets there, she will take care of my son and take care of their daughter, and vice versa. I knew my Brother was a bit under the weather, but I was not expecting that the Lord Almighty would summon him so soon.

5:10 p.m.

Mr Speaker, before we rose, in fact, even on that day, he was with me. We spoke at length. When the children came for vacation, we were supposed to meet. The understanding was that we were going to meet and have a joint family meeting for the Christmas because all the children were back from school. Then that unfortunate morning, the text message came from Hajia that “Leader, your Brother is gone”. How? Very sad.

Mr Speaker, I have never been to a cemetery since I became an adult, but I said on this occasion, he is a true Brother and for me, there is nothing like friendship. One must honour it till casket, even at the peril of one’s life. A true friend is difficult to find. So, I went to the Madina Cemetery where my Brother had been brought for final rites and I made sure I touched him and helped lower him into his grave with honour. Let me thank the family members for allowing me the opportunity to be part of that last rite of honour. I felt satisfied because he was a true Brother who shared with me the relevant code of life.

Mr Speaker, that said, I would want to urge all of us—The work we do in this Chamber is very demanding. Let us find time to do our check-ups. Let us find time to exercise. Do not let us underestimate the work we do. Two years or so ago, I was part of Colleagues who went for a training programme in the United States. We met some senators, and when we shared experiences, we realised that those of us from this part of

the world take political leadership for granted. One senator said he had a psychic advisor, had a psychiatrist, had a communication director, has a sports whatever, *et cetera*. All these are specialists that he pays to assist him because the workload is not easy. Constituents come to Members for money and for everything. One needs to prepare oneself for this Chamber. Sometimes the money is not even there. Mr Speaker, there have been times that I had gone to Winneba, shared money, and on my way back, my driver had told me that “Chief, *fuel no, akɔ fɔm. Asɔ red.*” Not once, not twice, several times, that I did not have money at the time.

Mr Speaker, there are a lot of sad stories that my Colleagues here know we go through. So, I will beg of all of us, we have a family to live for. Let us not assume that this political engagement is trivial; It is not. Do not let us take it for granted. Let us look at all areas and take care of them so that we will be effective in this Chamber. Because the law is clear, very mandatory that if a Member is not there, elections should be organised within 30 days. People will be fighting for seat in primaries and all.

Mr Speaker, that said, may the gentle soul of our Brother rest in perfect peace. He was such a great soul, very loving, caring, affable, easy of address, courteous in manners, and able to accommodate friends on all sides, and I loved the friendship we struck.

I thank you, Mr Speaker, for this gracious opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you. I will now give the floor to the Deputy Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, Hon Yusif Sulemana.

Deputy Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Yusif Sulemana): Mr Speaker, I am grateful for this opportunity. Let me first of all thank the Deputy Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts who read this very important tribute. Let me also thank my senior Colleagues who have already said very good things about our Brother, Alhaji Naser Toure Mahama.

Indeed, for me as a Muslim, I want to bear witness to the good things that he has done as a Muslim. I am the chairman of the Muslim Caucus, and so it is imperative for me to bear witness to what he has done as a Muslim. But before I continue, I want to make reference to the Holy Quran, Chapter 2, Verse 155-156, which says that:

“Walanabluwannakum bishay-in mina alkhawfi waljooAAi wanaqsin mina al-amwali wal-anfusi waththamarati wabashshiri assabireen.

Allatheena itha asabat-hummuseebatun qaloo inna lillahi wa-innailayhi rajiAAoon

To wit,

“And we certainly shall test you with anger, with loss of fruits, with loss of lives, and with loss of so many things. But we expect that you shall endure when we test you if you are a Muslim. And you shall also

know that it is from me, Allah, that you have come from, and it is to me that you will return”.

Again, the Quran says that: *Kullu nafs in zaikatul maut*, to wit, “Every soul shall taste death”. And so, we are not surprised when our Brother had to leave, because as Muslims we are very certain that one day he would return to his creator. And it is just for us all to know that when death is coming, it will not announce its arrival. And so, for us as Muslims, we know it can come at any time, and if it has come and he is gone, we can only praise Allah for giving him to us and for making him use his life to serve his people the way he did.

Mr Speaker, I said to myself and to all of us that I am here to bear witness to what he has done as a Muslim. I can testify that Hon Naser has fulfilled all the five pillars of Islam. He has said what we call the *Khalima*, believing that there is none to worship but Allah, and that the Prophet Muhammad (S.A.W.) is his messenger. He has done that several times, and I can bear witness to that. I can also bear witness to the fact that he was always with us in the mosque every Friday to pray. Sometimes by the time we get there, he was already sitting there. Sometimes when one is leaving, he was just sitting there supplicating. And so, we want to bear witness that he fulfilled that other pillar of Islam.

Again, when it comes to the payment of what we call *Zakat*, we can also bear witness that he has fulfilled that pillar. When it comes to the performance of Hajj, he has also performed *Hajj* several

times and I remember last year or so, I was on the same flight with him going to Mecca to perform *Umrah*. It was when we got to Medina that he felt unwell and had to return to Ghana. It tells how committed he was to his religion, how committed he was to serve Allah. That even when he was not well, he was still going to Mecca to worship his creator. That is the kind of person we are talking about. So, for me, *Inshallah*, our Hon Colleague should be in paradise. *Inshallah*.

Again, he served on several committees as his contribution to the Muslim Caucus. Any time there was a meeting, Hon Naser was always there and he contributed immensely to our discussions. There were very sensitive issues that came up at our meetings and my Hon Colleagues here would bear me witness how calm he was in addressing those issues. And so today, if we have lost him, we can only praise Allah because we did nothing and he was given to us, and we did nothing and God has taken him. We need to praise God and I can assure us that it is a place all of us will go. It was his time to go and he is gone.

We pray that the good Lord will have mercy on him and grant him *jannatul firdaus*. We want to also share our condolences with the wife, the children, and the family and to say that God will replace him in a manner that they will be alright. With these few words, once again, I want to thank my uncle, Hon Yussif Jajah. I want to thank my senior Colleagues who have shared their

experiences with our Brother who, today, as we speak, *inshallah*, is resting with his creator. Thank you.

5:20 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It is now the turn of Hon Matthew Nyindam.

Mr Matthew Nyindam (NPP — Kpandai): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to also pay tribute to my good Friend, Alhaji Naser Mahama.

Mr Speaker, Alhaji and I came to the Chamber on the same day. I did not know him, so when we all walked in, and they mentioned that I was the MP for Kpandai, he walked up to me and told me I was his MP because he shared roots in Kpandai. He mentioned that the 1992 conflict brought him back to Accra. Since then, he has never gone back to Kpandai.

Mr Speaker, from that day, Alhaji took me as a brother. Any time we met at the coffee shop; he spoke to me as a brother. Although we all belong to different political parties, Alhaji was not excessively partisan. He took everybody as a brother. He was not the loud type. Alhaji will not speak much, but Alhaji had a lot of wisdom. He was very calm, gentle and affable.

Mr Speaker, death, as we all know, is a journey we will all embark on. But after we are no more, what will people say about us? It is so important. I pray, and I

am with the family. When I heard that Alhaji was no more, I wished I had the opportunity to accompany Alhaji to his resting place. But unfortunately, Mr Speaker, I was in crisis. So, there was no way I could avail myself to accompany Alhaji.

Mr Speaker, there is this belief in Islam that when they are going to the cemetery, as many as we can, we accompany the dead body to the cemetery. This is something I appreciate a lot. Although Alhaji is not with us, I do not know the family personally. I wish and pray that the good Lord will be with them, and may the good Lord give him a perfect rest, and may his soul rest in perfect peace.

Thank you, Mr Speaker. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member.

Ms Patricia Appiagyei: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

I am not adding my voice to the tribute that is being said here. I think when we were at Conclave, we were very clear on the items that we were taking up. The admission of this Statement was not part of it. I think we have stayed far too long in the day. I agree with you. I have also seen an admission of a report over here. If I rise to talk about an issue of this nature, I was out among the people taking their blood pressure, and they were observing what was happening. I

would like to plead with you to wrap up and let people rest for the day.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Leader, the time for Sitting is five hours. Have we exceeded the five hours?

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, indeed, we have not. But let the record reflect that it was agreed that we would take this Statement because it was about an Hon Colleague.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, it is not a matter of agreeing to take the Statement because of an Hon Colleague or not. Our Standing Orders makes it clear that Sitting hours are five hours.

Mr Dafeamekpor: We have not exceeded.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, it is only when we exceed the five hours that we can talk about extension of the Sitting. But today we started after two o'clock, or around three o'clock.

So, Hon Deputy Minority Leader, we are still within the prescribed five hours of Sitting. We have not exceeded it.

Ms Appiagyei: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Well guided. But I would also like to remind ourselves that when we agree to do Business of the day to a certain point, we should try to adhere to it. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, this takes me to Order 55(3), which reads: "A

Sitting of the House shall ordinarily be for five hours.” We can all look at it. If, at the pre-Sitting, you have agreed on something else, we are masters of our own rules.

Majority Leader, what was the agreement at pre-Sitting? Has there been a decision at pre-sitting that will sit below the five hours as prescribed by Order 55(3)?

Mr Ayariga: No, Mr Speaker. I was not there, so I am not bound by any decision that was taken. No, but why do they want to leave early? This is the first day. We have been on recess for a very long time now. We have been resting throughout. It is the first day, and they are eager to leave. Or they spent their time campaigning and engaging in the presidential primaries. They should have known that there is Parliament too.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us conclude it by taking Hon Laadi Ayamba.

Hajia Laadi Ayii Ayamba (NDC — Pusiga): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to contribute to the Statement made by my Hon Colleague, Hon Jajah.

Mr Speaker, Alhaji Naser Toure was one of the individuals whom one can refer to and reflect about when it comes to his gentility. This is a man who spoke very gently. It is one of the observations I had made about him. What he would

simply say to me if we met was, “Hajia, how are you?”

Hon Naser Toure was always present, basically at all our committee meetings on roads and transport. Mr Speaker, I recall during one of our fasting seasons, we were in the Chamber here, and it was very late. All of us as Muslims wanted to just leave and go to break our fast. When we went to the coffee shop to get some water, he said, “Hajia, please wait. My wife is going to bring some food.” We were surprised because more than enough was given. She brought the food.

5:30 p.m.

We sat together, and it was so nice. Hon Naser Toure Mahama never ever raised his voice, and he ensured that he spoke calmly, no matter what was being discussed. It has been said, and as my Colleagues have mentioned—I have not been to an Arabic school, although I am a staunch Muslim. I believe that there is a time and season for everything, so it is with life. Much as we do not know when it was given, we believe that at the time the Almighty Allah made that seed to be planted—We did not know, and nobody has ever known, except He alone.

The Almighty Allah has also stated clearly, “*Inna lillahi wa inna ilayhi raji'un*”, to wit, from Him, each one of us has come and to Him we shall return. There is no time, no day, no place and no circumstance that is known by any individual as to how, when, or where we will pass. We owe death if we do not owe anybody, and each and every one of

us must be ready. For that matter, it is a lesson for all of us. All that I can say is that let us believe that as we hear, see, and observe others pass, so is it incumbent on us that one day, no matter what, whether we are ready or not, we will also pass. The only prayer we have is that all the good things that we do on earth should follow us into our final resting places.

Mr Speaker, I pray that the Almighty Allah grants our Brother, Hon Naser Toure Mahama *Jannatul Firdaus*, and that he should also grant us the living, long life and prosperity. One day, when it is our turn, we shall also go in peace. My condolences to his wife, the family, and everyone.

Mr Speaker, thank you for the Statement and for listening to me.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Nii Ashie Kotey, then I will come to the Leadership.

Mr Alfred Nii Kotey Ashie (NDC — Odododiodioo): I want to take the opportunity to thank my big Brother, the Hon Deputy Minister, Mr Jajah, for the Statement made. I also want to add my voice to say that may the soul of Mr Naser Toure Mahama rest well in the bosom of Allah.

When I entered Parliament, I remember how he met me, stretched forth his arms and welcomed me, and said, “Gentleman, you are welcome to Parliament”. He shared how he observed the elections in my Constituency, Odododiodioo, and I recall very well how he said, “you are such a

strong young man”. Meanwhile, I know I am quite calm and reserved.

Mr Speaker, getting to know him well, even though people had said that I was too calm for a constituency like Odododiodioo, I said no, for a man presiding over a constituency which is predominantly a Muslim community, he was a little too calm for that. He would call me, and he would advise, and say that, “you know, as you are here, you do not have to do this, or do that, and this is the way to go”. So, I saw a father figure in him. So, indeed, he was fatherly. Truly, he was very approachable, and I must also confess that he was humble and affectionate.

When I became a member of the leadership of the Greater Accra Members of Parliament (MPs) Caucus, I would confer with him to share with me and guide me on the way to go. The news, obviously, of his death, became shocking to all of us. I recall when the call came, I said no, it could not be true. So, I started calling Hon Colleagues. When it was confirmed, in fact, I became, for want of a better word, disabled. I could not move; I could not think. We have lost a great leader. We have lost a calm gentleman. We have lost a man with a wealth of knowledge and experience, just as he has been praised. We take solace in the fact that his legacy will speak well of him.

I wish the family, especially the wife and daughter, my deepest condolences,

and on behalf of the Greater Accra MPs' Caucus, we say, *inshallah*, he should indeed be in paradise.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Dr Abdul-Rashid Hassan Pelpuo (NDC — Wa Central): Mr Speaker, I also rise to contribute to the Statement and to say that this man who lived and died, died as a great man. In Shakespeare, a character said that all the world is a stage, and all the men and women merely players, but a man in his life plays many parts. In the life of Mr Naser Toure Mahama, he played many parts. He played several parts out of the country. It dawned on him to come to Ghana, and he came to Ghana, contributed his quota, represented his people, committed himself to their service and to God's service.

Mr Speaker, I interacted with him several times, especially when we served in the same Committee. As a member of the Committee on Energy at the time, we worked very closely together. He is not a man who talked much, but he is a man who taught much, and in his personal life, he did so much that I believe his family would miss him a lot.

I wish to, first of all, extend my deepest condolences to his wife and kids for everything he represented in their lives and for the huge loss in their lives.

Mr Speaker, one thing I learned from him is that no matter who you are, continue to be humble. I have a symbolic representation in that aspect in my own life, but in the life of Mr Mahama Toure, he showed that in his wealth, he was still himself. In his endeavour as a politician, he was still himself.

5:40 p.m.

He lived a life that a man who rises to see what he has done can only salute him. In this contribution, I want to wish him well in the sight of Allah. I know that by what he represented, by everything he did, he did it because he thought that one day he would no longer be on earth. This has taught us a lesson. I believe we all have to learn that lesson.

We have heard about great men who have passed on. One of the greatest who passed on was Alexander the Great, a man who ruled almost all the world. Before he got to 40 years, he died. His death is another reminder that as we are all here, we are marching towards one simple destination; a destination where we will be oblivious of this world; we will die, and our deaths will be forgotten by a future generation. It tells us that what will be left is the deeds we would have performed. This man performed so much that every member of his constituency you met would still tell you they wanted him to contest the elections. I interacted with several of them during the funeral, and they regretted that he died so soon. Mr Speaker, let me extend

my condolences to all of them; the constituents, his wife, his children and everybody who thinks so much about him, and who have been touched by his exit from this world. May his great soul rest in perfect peace. Amen.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Leadership?

Well, in the absence of any further contribution from the Minority Side, I will give the floor to Hon Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe, being that of the Majority Leadership.

First Deputy Majority Whip (Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity. I would like to thank Hon Jajah, the Deputy Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts, for the Statement. Mr Speaker, it is with deep sadness that we say goodbye to a wonderful Colleague and Friend, the late Hon Naser Toure Mahama. Mr Speaker, in 2013, we were ushered in as new MPs, and in Greater Accra, we were five. Hon Edwin Nii Lante Vanderpuye, Hon Christian Corleytey Otuteye, Hon Emmanuel Nii Ashie Moore, Hon Naser Toure Mahama and me. We grew ourselves together as sisters, brothers and colleagues, and we worked together. Along the line, three were out and I was left with Hon Naser. Recently, in this Eighth Parliament, he became our Caucus Chairperson.

Mr Speaker, Hon Naser, as a Caucus Chairperson, was so wonderful. His

dedication, kindness, and humour, cannot be taken away from him. He brought some calmness in the Caucus. Anytime he is available, we see that the place is different, because he is a different person altogether. Hon Naser, little did I know he would pass away. We were here before we went on recess. Before then, I can remember when he wanted to be the Chairperson of the Committee on Energy and he could not get it, we told him he will get a board membership, so it should not be a big deal. He said “No problem, but Hon Doyoe, I would like that board to go to my spouse, which is my wife”. I said he was the MP. But, he insisted saying “No, I want everything to go to her, so that she can take good care of the children”. He did not add “when he is no more”. I did not know he was even going to pass.

Mr Speaker, in fact, I received the news with shock. That day, I started having a runny tummy, because he was somebody whom I could call a brother, a friend and a father. Any time, any day, and anything, he would consult me and say “Leader, what do you think?” I also consulted him as a Caucus Chairperson. We worked together and did everything together.

Mr Speaker, Hon Naser has left a huge vacuum when it comes to unity and work.

Mr Speaker, I will take the opportunity to console the wife, the family, and the children. I now understand why he kept

telling me that if anything, I should push it to his wife. He said “for board membership, push it to my wife”. I asked, why? He said “no, just give it to my wife”. Not knowing, he knows what is going to happen. I think now he will be resting in the bosom of the Lord.

I wish his wife and the children well. I also wish his family and the NDC in Ayawaso East well. May God console all of us. *[Interruption]* That was what he said, that we should give everything to the wife.

Today, as we are here paying tribute to him, we will visit the wife as a Caucus and then console her. He died when we were on recess, so we could not do the needful. We will now go to the house and do the needful. The Ayawaso East Constituency executives will fix a time and a date, and we will meet all of them as a Caucus and console them.

May his soul rest in perfect peace. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, that brings us to the end of Statement; Statement time has ended. Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I want to crave your indulgence so that we take the Motion numbered 12, that is the Legal Education Reform Bill, the Second Reading of the Bill. The Report of the Committee is ready, so if we could just take that one and then call it a day. It is

the only substantive Government Business that would have been taken today.

The Chairperson of the Committee is here—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Leader, have you looked at the item numbered 9(b)?

Mr Ayariga: Are they ready?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It has not been laid, so the Second Reading is not due.

Mr Ayariga: All right, the item numbered 9(b).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members— Yes, Minority Side?

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Mr Speaker, we are not opposed to its laying.

5:50 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, at the commencement of Public Business, the item numbered 9 (b).

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think earlier, the Rt Hon Speaker indicated that we would wait until after a Statement is made in honour of our Colleague, then request for a one-minute silence.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Thank you very much for that reminder.

Hon Members, may we be on our feet to observe a minute of silence.

[A minute of silence was observed.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: May his gentle soul rest in the bosom of the almighty Allah.

At the commencement of public Business, the item numbered 9(b). Chairman of the Committee?

PAPER

By the Chairperson of the Committee

Report of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs on the Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: We can now take the item numbered 11 then 12. The Attorney-General and Minister for Justice is here to assist us with the item numbered 11.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, we are not opposed to it.

MOTION

Suspension of Standing Order 104 (1)

Attorney-General and Minister for Justice (Dr Dominic Akuritinga Ayine): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a Motion shall not be debated until at least two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the Motion is given, the Motion for the Second Reading of the Security and Intelligence Agencies Bill, 2025 may be *moved* today.

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Shaibu Mahama): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Now the substantive Motion numbered 12 standing in the name of the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice. You have the floor.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will now take the Motion numbered 12.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, that is why I said the substantive Motion standing in the name of the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice. So, I am giving the floor to the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice.

Mr Shaib: I was just wondering if the Chairperson has indicated this to the Ranking Member. I am sure he would have loved to contribute on this very important Motion. I do not know if he is aware. This obviously came at our blindside, but we also do not want to drag it. My only wish is that we could just engage and perhaps have it scheduled for tomorrow, so that he would have his

Committee Members also debate on it. That is just my objective view, but if they think differently, that is fine.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, at the Business Committee meeting, I did indicate strongly that today we will take the Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025 and the Report. My counterpart agreed that we should go ahead. Everybody, including the Minority Chief Whip agreed that we should go ahead. The Ranking Member was here and I even spoke with him in one of the corridors earlier.

We need to move fast. This is really the problem, that we come, treat Business, and then in the end we will keep deferring, postponing, then the day we are going to rise we will be forcing people to stay here till midnight. I do not want that. In fact, in the opening Statement, we indicated that we are not going to adopt that approach. We are going to treat Government Business with dispatch. So, Mr Speaker, I think we can take the Second Reading, and then the Committee's Report, so that later on, when we come to the Consideration Stage, we can mobilise all the Members. I plead with you to let us take it.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, I have indicated my difficulty, but as we can see, they have the numbers, so if they still want to proceed, there is no objection on this matter. I thought that for purposes of communality and progress, we should also be thinking of all of this. If the Ranking Member were

to be around, I would have even felt more comfortable, because this is legal education, and he is a lawyer, Mr Speaker is a lawyer, the Majority Leader is a lawyer, the Majority Chief Whip is also a lawyer.

I only sighted this an hour ago, and we have even elapsed to say that we are not going to take it for the number of days it was supposed to be. We looked at the item numbered 11, so we have considered that the time should be elapsed. But if time has been lapsed, then we still want to proceed – it is alright. I mean, like I said, the normal thing is that we engage the Ranking Members. But if he can say on record that he has engaged his Ranking Member, that is fine.

BILL — SECOND READING

Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025

Attorney-General and Minister for Justice (Dr Dominic Akuritinga Ayine): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That the Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025 be now read a Second time.

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Shaibu Mahama): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Which Motion? I called on you to present the Committee's Report.

Mr S. Mahama: I am presenting the Report, and I shall be very brief on this Report.

Introduction

The Legal Education Bill, 2025 was laid in Parliament by the Hon Attorney-General and Minister for Justice Dr Dominic Akuritinga Ayine on Friday, 24th October, 2025.

In accordance with Article 106(4) of the 1992 Constitution and Order 238 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Bill was referred to the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs for consideration and report.

Deliberations

In considering the referral, the Committee met on Sunday, 11th January 2026, with the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, the Chief Director, and officials from the Ministry of Justice and Attorney-General's Department, as well as the Conference of Law Deans (COLD) from various universities. Officials from the Drafting Division of the Attorney-General's Department were also in attendance.

The Committee expresses its profound gratitude to the Hon Minister and the officials for their attendance and assistance in the Committee's deliberations.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents during its deliberations:

- i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;

- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament of Ghana;
- iii. Legal Profession Act, 1960 (Act 32);
- iv. Legal Education Bill, 2025
- v. Legal Profession (Professional and Post-Call Law Course Regulations, 2018 (L.I. 2355).

Background

The history of legal education in Ghana dates back to the period immediately following independence in 1957. At that time, the training of legal practitioners was governed by the Legal Practitioners Ordinance (Cap. 8) as amended by the Legal Practitioners Act, 1958 (No. 22). The 1958 Act established the General Legal Council (GLC) and mandated it, among other functions, to organise legal education in Ghana. Pursuant to this mandate, the General Legal Council established the Ghana School of Law as the institution responsible for providing professional legal training. The Act also created the Board of Legal Education, which was empowered to administer and supervise legal education, develop and establish courses of instruction, conduct examinations, and publish examination results for admission to the Ghana Bar.

The legal framework was subsequently consolidated under the Legal Profession Act, 1960 (Act 32), which repealed the earlier enactments. Act 32 was intended to amend and consolidate the law relating to the legal profession by

integrating the regulation of legal education and training with the regulation of legal practice. However, a close examination of Act 32 reveals that it deals more comprehensively with matters relating to the regulation of professional practice than with the regulation of professional legal education and training.

This legislative structure has proved problematic in two principal respects. First, Act 32 leaves professional legal education and training largely unregulated, as it does not provide a comprehensive framework governing curriculum development, accreditation, delivery, and assessment of professional legal education. Second, the Act conflates the regulation of professional legal education with the regulation of professional legal practice by vesting both functions in a single body, namely the General Legal Council, notwithstanding the delegation of certain administrative responsibilities to the Board of Legal Education.

These structural deficiencies have compounded over the past six decades. Despite the passage of time, little progress has been made towards the formulation of comprehensive rules and regulations specifically tailored to address the challenges of professional legal education and training. Although subsidiary legislation such as the Legal Profession (Professional and Post-Call Law Course) Regulations, 2018 (L.I. 2355), the Legal Profession (Professional Conduct and Etiquette) Rules, 2020 (L.I. 2423), and the Legal Profession (Disciplinary Committee)

Rules, 2020 (L.I. 2424) currently regulate aspects of the legal profession, these Instruments do not adequately address the contemporary challenges facing professional legal education and training in Ghana.

Under the Act 32 regime, the Ghana School of Law, a public institution, has operated as the sole provider of professional legal education. Historically, this arrangement posed little difficulty. In the early years, nearly all students admitted to the Ghana School of Law were graduates of the University of Ghana, which was then the only institution offering the Bachelor of Laws degree. Up to about the year 2000, the University of Ghana produced an average of approximately 70 law graduates annually, most of whom were almost automatically admitted into the Qualifying Certificate programme at the Ghana School of Law. During this period, the system functioned with minimal strain.

However, the landscape of legal education has changed significantly in recent years. There has been a substantial increase in the number of universities in Ghana offering the Bachelor of Laws degree, leading to a corresponding increase in the number of law graduates eligible for professional training. In addition, a growing number of Ghanaians now obtain law degrees or equivalent qualifications from other common law and analogous jurisdictions, including the United Kingdom, the United States of America, South Africa, Australia, India, and Nigeria.

These developments have exposed serious capacity constraints within the Ghana School of Law. The institution has become increasingly unable, in terms of infrastructure, human resources, financing, and administrative capacity, to admit and train all qualified applicants in accordance with Act 32. As a result, the existing model of professional legal education has become misaligned with the realities of modern Ghana, particularly the demands of the legal services market, both in terms of quantity and quality of legal practitioners.

It is against this background that the Legal Education Bill, 2025 is proposed. The Bill seeks to introduce legislative measures aimed at expanding access to professional legal education while maintaining high standards in learning and teaching outcomes. Central to this reform is the separation of the regulation of legal education from the regulation of the legal profession, while simultaneously strengthening the role of the Bar in maintaining educational standards.

The Object of the Bill

The object of the Bill is to establish the Council for Legal Education and Training to regulate professional legal education in Ghana and provide the curriculum and standards for legal education.

To achieve these objectives, the Bill proposes to move professional legal education and training from the Ghana School of Law to accredited universities. It introduces a Law Practice Training

Course, to be offered by accredited universities, which will prepare candidates for a National Bar Examination. The Law Practice Training Course will emphasise clinical legal education and the acquisition of practical lawyering skills, rather than purely theoretical instruction. Holders of the Bachelor of Laws degree or other approved first degrees in law will be required to gain admission to this course before qualifying to sit the National Bar Examination.

Summary of Provisions

The Bill consists of a total of eighty-eight clauses.

Clause 1 of the Bill establishes the Council for Legal Education and Training as a body corporate. The object of the Council, as specified in clause 2, is to regulate legal education in the country. This is followed by provisions covering the functions of the Council, the Governing body of the Council, functions of the Board from clauses 3 to 5.

Standard provisions on the tenure of office of members of the Board, the meetings of the Board, disclosure of interest, the establishment of committees and allowances are provided for in clauses 6 to 10 respectively.

Clauses 11 to 14 provide for the administration of the Council. These encompass the appointment of the Registrar, the functions of the Registrar, the appointment of other staff of the Council, and the internal audit unit respectively.

The Bill caters for financial matters of the Council in clauses 15 to 18. This covers funds of the Council, bank account of the Council, accounts and audit, as well as annual report and other reports.

The next set of provisions from clauses 19 to 34 deals with the accreditation of universities to provide the Law Practice Training. This includes standards for accreditation of universities, requirement to obtain accreditation, application for accreditation, consideration of application, issue of provisional accreditation licence, requirement to obtain full accreditation licence, application for full accreditation licence, consideration for full accreditation licence, consideration of application for full accreditation licence, issue of full accreditation licence, display of accreditation licence, publication of accreditation licence, suspension of accreditation licence, restoration of suspended accreditation licence, revocation of accreditation licence, inspection of accredited universities and appeal respectively.

Matters relating to the administration of a law degree programme of a university are dealt with in clauses 35 to 42. This covers the administration of law degree programme, Dean of law degree programme, functions of the Dean, the Administrator of law degree programme, functions of the Administrator, accounts officer of law degree programme, functions of accounts officer and the records of law degree programme.

Clauses 43 to 45 deal with requirements for admission to a Bachelor of Laws degree programme. This includes admission examination and entrance standards, non-discriminatory admission measures and admission measures for persons with disability respectively.

Provision is made in clauses 46 to 53, for the academic curriculum and methodology for legal education. This covers the curriculum for Bachelor of Laws degree programme, content of curriculum, minimum requirements for Bachelor of Laws degree, the form and standards of assessment, grading standards, review of grades, teaching method and duration of Bachelor of Laws degree programme.

Scholastic standards are provided for in clauses 54 to 59.

This encapsulates scholastic standards for legal education, retention, academic disqualification and graduation policies, evaluation of students for advancement and retention purposes, disqualification for failure in assessment, repetition of courses and academic freedom.

Clauses 60 and 61 make provision for Law Practice Training upon completion of the Bachelor of Laws Degree programme. This covers the law practice training and duration of law practice training respectively.

Provision is made for the National Bar Examination Committee under clauses 62 to 65. This encompasses the establishment of the National Bar

Examination Committee, functions of the National Bar Examination Committee, tenure of office of members of the National Bar Examination Committee and meetings of the National Bar Examination Committee.

The conduct of the National Bar Examination is provided for in clauses 66 to 70. This covers the mode of conduct of National Bar Examination, qualifications to sit for National Bar Examinations, areas of law to be covered in National Bar Examination, form of and standards for National Bar Examination and re-sit of National Bar Examination.

Clauses 71 and 72 deal with enrolment on the Roll of Lawyers. This includes the qualification for enrolment and issue of qualifying certificate respectively.

Clause 73 provides for the conduct of the Post-Call Law Course and remedial courses for re-sitting the National Bar Examination.

Clauses 74 to 81 make provision for the Legal Education Reform Appeals Tribunal. This covers establishment of the Legal Education Reform Appeals Tribunal, composition of the Tribunal, administration of the Tribunal, rules of procedure of the Tribunal, right of appeal, decisions of the Tribunal and appeal against decision of the Tribunal.

Miscellaneous matters are dealt with in clauses 82 to 87.

This includes requests for information, regulations, interpretation, revocation, consequential amendments and savings.

Finally, transitional matters are dealt with in clause 88.

Observations and Recommendations

The Committee made the following recommendations during the deliberation:

Policy Rationale

The Committee observed that the Bill seeks to respond to long-standing concerns regarding access to legal education, quality assurance, institutional capacity, and governance of professional legal training.

It was revealed that the Bill is intended to modernise Ghana's legal education framework to align with constitutional values, evolving legal practice, and contemporary educational standards. It was indicated that the Bill reflects policy objectives of widening access while safeguarding professional competence.

It was disclosed that the passage of the Bill would reduce the monopolistic control of the Ghana Legal Council (GLC), which has exercised near-exclusive control over professional legal education, including admissions, curriculum approval, examinations, and certification. The Bill curtails this concentration of power by restructuring the governance of legal education and

opening professional training to a broader, more regulated institutional framework. This represents a shift from exclusivity to shared oversight.

Access to Legal Education

The Committee noted that the Bill explicitly aims to enhance access to professional legal education by addressing capacity constraints at the Ghana School of Law, which struggles with surging Bachelor Laws (LLB) graduates from multiple Ghanaian universities and foreign jurisdictions.

It was proffered that there is an urgent need to enhance capacity expansion by shifting training to accredited universities via a new Law Practice Training Course decentralizes delivery, allowing multiple institutions to absorb more students beyond the Ghana School of Law's diminished infrastructure, human resources, and finances. It was indicated that accredited universities would have to satisfy some standards such as libraries, IT facilities and staff ratios.

The Committee was informed that allowing for accreditation of multiple institutions and diversified training pathways would reduce monopoly concerns and expand opportunities for qualified candidates. This is consistent with principles of fairness, inclusivity, and equal educational opportunity.

Curriculum and Training Reforms

The Committee observed that the Bill introduces targeted reforms to curricula

and training, shifting from theory-based models to practical, skills-based education aligned with modern legal demands.

Regarding the curriculum, it was indicated that the Council would collaborate with the universities to develop minimum curriculum standards. It was also disclosed that universities should be permitted to supplement these standards based on their institutional focus, specialisations and strategic objectives.

On review of the curriculum, it was indicated that the framework should be reviewed every five years rather than annually after it has been used to teach batches of students over a number of academic cycles.

The Committee noted that these minimum standards would ensure consistency and quality across all institutions while preserving institutional autonomy and encouraging innovation in legal education.

Regulatory Oversight and Accountability

The Committee observed that the Bill establishes a robust regulatory framework through the new Council for Legal Education and Training, separating legal education oversight from practice regulation under the General Legal Council.

It was noted that the Bill would strengthen regulatory oversight through clearer supervisory powers, reporting obligations, and compliance

mechanisms. These provisions are expected to reduce arbitrariness and ensure that regulatory bodies operate within defined statutory limits, subject to accountability and due process.

The Committee was optimistic that vesting regulatory functions in a separate Council would enhance legal education in Ghana, ensuring focused oversight and specialized expertise in legal educational standards.

Quality Assurance and Standards

The Committee noted that the Bill embeds quality assurance through rigorous standards set and enforced by the Council for Legal Education and Training across accreditation, curricula, admissions, and examinations.

While expanding access, the Bill places strong emphasis on maintaining professional standards. The Committee was informed that the mechanisms for accreditation, monitoring, and periodic review of institutions and curricula are central to the Bill.

It was indicated that this dual focus on access and quality is commendable, as it seeks to prevent dilution of professional competence while meeting increasing demand.

Clinical Legal Education and Professional Skills Development

The Committee observed that the Bill places deliberate emphasis on clinical legal education and the acquisition of practical professional skills as a core

component of legal training. This marks a significant departure from the traditionally theory-heavy approach to legal education and reflects an appreciation of the realities of modern legal practice. By mandating structured practical training, the Bill seeks to ensure that graduates of professional legal education are not only knowledgeable in the law but are also competent in its application.

It was indicated that the Bill would promote experiential learning through supervised clinical programmes, practical attachments, and skills-based instruction. These measures are designed to expose students to real-life legal problems, client interaction, ethical decision-making, advocacy, legal drafting, negotiation, and alternative dispute resolution. Such exposure is essential in bridging the gap between academic study and professional practice.

Furthermore, the Committee noted that embedding clinical legal education within the statutory framework enhances ethical consciousness and professional responsibility among prospective lawyers. Through clinical programmes, students are introduced early to the values of integrity, accountability, access to justice, and service to the public—values which are foundational to the legal profession.

In sum, the Committee observed that the Bill's provisions on clinical legal education and professional skills development are timely, progressive, and aligned with international best practices

in legal education, and should be fully supported and effectively implemented.

Erosion of public confidence in the legal education system

The Committee observed that a key underlying concern addressed by the Bill is the erosion of public confidence in the legal education system occasioned by perceived opacity, inconsistency, and inefficiencies in the administration of professional legal training. Over time, public dissatisfaction has grown due to limited access, unclear admission criteria, protracted processes, and recurrent disputes surrounding the governance of legal education. The Bill seeks to restore confidence by providing a clearer, more transparent, and predictable statutory framework.

In addition, it was indicated that the Bill introduces structured regulatory mechanisms, objective standards, and defined institutional responsibilities, which are intended to reduce arbitrariness and enhance fairness in decision-making. By codifying procedures relating to accreditation, curriculum development, and assessment, the Bill responds directly to public concerns about unequal treatment and lack of accountability within the legal education system.

Furthermore, the Committee observed that the Bill's emphasis on quality assurance, professional competence, and practical skills development is designed to address public perceptions that graduates of the system are inadequately prepared for legal practice.

Strengthening training outcomes is expected to improve the quality of legal services, thereby reinforcing public trust in the legal profession as a whole.

In the view of the Committee, the cumulative effect of these reforms is to promote transparency, accessibility, and professional excellence, which are essential to restoring and sustaining public confidence. The Committee therefore observed that the Bill, if effectively implemented, has the potential to rebuild trust in the legal education system and enhance the credibility of the administration of justice.

Stakeholder Impact

The Committee observed that the Bill has wide-ranging implications for multiple stakeholders within the legal education and justice delivery ecosystem, including law students, legal practitioners, tertiary institutions, regulatory bodies, the Judiciary, and the general public. The Committee noted that the reforms proposed under the Bill are intended to rebalance stakeholder interests while promoting efficiency, fairness, and professional competence.

Overall, the Committee observed that while the Bill presents transitional and operational challenges for some stakeholders, its long-term benefits outweigh the short-term adjustments required, and the Bill represents a balanced and inclusive reform of the legal education framework.

Proposed Amendments

During its deliberations, the Committee proposed amendments to strengthen the provisions of the Bill which have been incorporated into the Bill.

Conclusion and Recommendation

The Committee, having examined and satisfied itself with the provisions of this Bill, recommends the passage of the Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025 subject to the proposed amendments.

Mr Speaker, your good self asked this Committee, in accordance with Article 106 (4) of the Constitution and Order 238 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, to refer the Bill to your Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs. The Hon Attorney-General and Minister for Justice Dr Dominic Akuritinga Ayine, on Friday 24th October, 2025 led this Report.

6:00 p.m.

Mr Speaker, your Committee deliberated on it. We invited a number of people, including institutions; indeed, the heads of various faculties of law in all the universities and training institutions of this country were present to deliberate on this. Mr Speaker, let me encourage the *Hansard* Department to capture the entire Report while I look at the critical areas.

Mr Speaker, may I conclude by saying that the Committee, having examined

and satisfied itself with the fact that access to legal education has been restricted for the past many years— Indeed, Mr Speaker, many years ago, you walked into the law school from the faculty. Times have changed. There is a pinhole now where people get in and cannot come out, and this Bill seeks to open up legal education. Mr Speaker, we recommend the passage of the Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025, subject to the proposed amendments.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion has been moved, and the Chairperson of the Committee has also presented the Committee's Report. Pursuant to Order 127, a full debate shall arise on the principles of the Bill on the basis of the explanatory memorandum and the report of the Committee. Hon Members, accordingly, the floor is now open. Hon Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah, MP for Ho West?

Mr Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah (NDC —Ho West): Mr Speaker, I rise to also support the Motion on the principle behind the creation of the Legal Education Bill, 2025. Mr Speaker, for those of us who are non-lawyers and desire to become lawyers, we have this fear that after we have done our PhD, we have to go back to the university to do our first degree in law for three years, after which we will be admitted to the so-called Makola School of Law. Even with that, it is tedious. And so, the Majority of

us who want to be lawyers are not able to penetrate into that legal environment. This is all because some group of people think this is the preserve of some perceived people, and that if we do not belong to that group, we can never become lawyers.

Mr Speaker, if you permit me, the object of this Bill states clearly in paragraph 5.0 that:

“The object of the Bill is to establish the Council for Legal Education and Training to regulate professional legal education in Ghana and provide a curriculum and standards for legal education.

To achieve this objective, the Bill proposed to move professional legal education and training from the Ghana School of Law to accredited universities. It introduces a Law Practice Training Course to be offered by accredited universities.”

Mr Speaker, this is novel. It is novel because, for me as a Quantity surveyor, I am trained at one of the technical universities in a specified field, and then I write a professional exam. It is only in legal education that one has to go to the Ghana School of Law. If one does not qualify to go to the Ghana School of Law, one cannot become a lawyer. What is this? One has to be in the market all the

time, and because of that, we have Kejetia lawyers and Makola lawyers. Now, we, the Kejetia lawyers, want to become Makola lawyers. And so, if at the University of Health and Allied Sciences —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Who is a Makola lawyer and who is a Kejetia lawyer?

Mr Bedzrah: Mr Speaker, have you watched the movie on Ghana Television (GTV), a comedy that says that we have Kejetia lawyers —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We are not debating the principle of a movie. We are debating the explanatory memorandum and the Report of the Committee.

Mr Bedzrah: Mr Speaker, those of us who want to become lawyers have the opportunity now to at least gain admission to accredited universities to be given the opportunity to become lawyers. Therefore, Mr Speaker, I support this Bill wholeheartedly and ask all my Colleagues to vote for this Bill. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan (NDC — Yendi): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to contribute to the Report currently before the House on the reforms to our legal education in Ghana. Mr Speaker, as a young lawyer, I would say that these reforms are late in coming. Some of us went through the system of

legal education at a time where we can say the system was choked. In fact, we had to write serious exams, we had to go through interviews, all in an attempt to pass through a very narrow hole, which to me was brought upon us by our own selves.

Mr Speaker, legal education should be open to everyone, especially as a country that is on its forward march to becoming a fully-fledged middle-income country. Mr Speaker, legal education promotes legal awareness, and to that extent that it is imperative that, as a society, we become aware of the laws around us. There is every need for us to expand the scope of our legal education to give opportunities to more people to become legally aware of the environment in which they live.

Mr Speaker, until recently, the northern part of the country was never given the opportunity to have any form of legal education, even an LLB. It was only two years ago that the LLB programme was introduced into the University for Development Studies. I am sure the first batch is yet to graduate. So, this reform, which would expand the scope and make even professional-level education available at these campuses, would further strengthen the Ghanaian populace and our legal education. I am happy that these reforms are not only looking at training lawyers, but they are also strengthening the other stakeholders who are all involved in the provision of legal education in Ghana.

Mr Speaker, I wish to commend the Committee that put together this Report, and for the extensive work that has been done. I call on all and sundry to join in embracing this call to expand the scope of our legal education in the country. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

6:10 p.m.

Mr Anthony Mmih (NPP — Odotobri): I am grateful, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to contribute towards the subject matter.

Mr Speaker, I would also say that this Bill is long overdue. When I entered the university to read law over 25 years ago, the system was different. The only university offering law at the time was the University of Ghana, which would admit 60 students. Then after what we used to call ‘baptism by fire’, that is the first university exams, there would be some sort of separation where the first 40 would read LLB and the next 20, making up the 60, would have a combination of law and some other course. It was not a problem at the time.

Over the years, the mode of admission has been problematic to the extent that the legal profession has been in the news lately for not so good reasons. It is unfortunate. If you look at the statistics, in 2021, out of the total number of students that wrote the entry exam, 72 per cent failed; in 2019, 93 per cent failed; and in 2023, 67 per cent failed. It is welcoming that we finally have a Bill which is streamlining legal education in this country. It is long overdue, and I say

it is very welcoming for the fact that it is going to increase access to legal education. My only concern is that I hope it will not open the floodgates for worse things to happen as we have in some of our neighbouring countries. You go to some of these places, and everybody you meet tells you he has an LLB and he is a lawyer. I will not mention names.

Mr Speaker, it is a good opportunity for all persons who intend to read law to go through the process, not to go through a rigorous process of writing examinations and attending interviews. It is a good idea that this Bill is being passed, because at the end of the day, it is only the universities that meet certain criteria, which has been specified in the Bill, would be allowed to run programmes of that nature, which would also help us churn out quality lawyers, even though the volumes are going to be a little bit higher than we are seeing currently.

In that light, I hope that our economy, our system, and this Government, including successive governments, would put in place measures to absorb the volumes that this system is going to produce. During our consideration of the Bill, I raised an issue to the effect that if you look at some of our institutions, the number of lawyers is woefully inadequate; take the Accra Metropolitan Assembly (AMA), for instance; take the Kumasi Metropolitan Assembly (KMA), for instance. Sometimes you have as few as two lawyers in those institutions. I hope that all these would be taken into consideration so that this wonderful Bill we have today, at the end of the day, does

not become one that would worsen our problems.

Mr Speaker, I am very grateful.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you so much, Hon Members. I will now give the floor to Hon Worlase Kpeli.

Mr Worlase Kpeli (NDC — Kwahu Afram Plains North): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for this opportunity to add my voice to the Report of the Committee, and in doing so, I would faithfully stand behind the Legal Education Reform Bill to say it is in the right direction.

Mr Speaker, from all the speakers who rose before me, it remains a fact that this Bill is long overdue. As a lawyer who acquired even my earlier legal education, not in Ghana, I have had some practice experiences outside Ghana. We have come to realise that the world has evolved beyond the static legal education that our common law fathers presented to us. May I say the “thereof” and “thereafter”, which had been handed over to us, for which even a lawyer to client ratio, we have been unable to meet. It is not surprising that you go to court and your clients do not understand the basic legal principles for which they should answer you a lawyer for you to make reference to in arguing out your case. That is not a good society within the context of law, at least when the ratio of lawyers to clients in the country, reflects the knowledge of the society on basic legal tenets of a particular society, which means if we lack that ratio, by the fact that there are impediments in the way of more people acquiring legal

knowledge, then we will lack that basic understanding as a country to move on in the process of our legal uprightness.

Mr Speaker, basically, education is about acquiring some knowledge and not a business in its entirety. But if you look at the Ghana legal system, it has become like an acquired business which must be limited to a class or a people, a family, or a kind of cult. And that is the worrying situation where you see the complaints about students who have gone through LLB, which is the principles of law itself, but are unable to just run through the procedures of applying those principles, that is the almighty “Makola”. In other jurisdictions, as I have been, legal education is free for all. But joining a bar association is where the professionals have their way of admitting those who want to practice with them. If this Bill and this Report is in that right direction, then Ghana is catching up with the world.

I am a practising lawyer in Rwanda, at least since 2018, I have been on the roll. The kind of education we have, I cannot say, has been that strenuous like I had in Ghana. I earned my LLB from the University of London, those that handed the legal system to us. But even with Ghana legal system and constitutional law alone, I have not been stressed in University of London like I have been stressed here. And equitably, you could find out as a student that some of the impediments are just to take you off. I am very glad the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice and the Committee as well have noticed all these, and have come up with this Report, and have

opened up access that we can argue out our point and make the recommended amendments to the Bill, so that our country, Ghana, can also open its doors so that people can access legal education. And when they want to practise, they can join the professional association as well.

Thank you for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It is now the turn of Hon Fiifi Buckman.

Mr Philip Fiifi Buckman (NDC — Kwesimintsim): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

6:20 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I humbly want to add my voice in calling upon Hon Members to support the adoption of the Report of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs.

Mr Speaker, I must say that all procedural and institutional measures have been captured in the Bill to ensure that quality legal education, both at the faculty and the practising education, is captured. This Bill will also be a great relief to parents and potential legal practitioners as it will eliminate the psychological trauma students go through as they face the almighty entrance exams at Makola.

Mr Speaker, this Bill is one of the biggest reliefs that His Excellency John Dramani Mahama is bringing to the legal education fraternity. As has been

captured in the Report, brilliant and professional ideas were sought. In fact, we had technical brains join the Committee in deliberating over the Bill and respectfully, the discussions were very rich, the contributions were very apt to ensure that we come out with such a Bill.

Let me commend the Attorney-General for this bold step in coming out with this Bill. I want to say that legal education has also had its bite in the reset agenda of His Excellency John Dramani Mahama. The Bill seeks to restore confidence by providing a clearer, more transparent and predictable statutory framework. It establishes an examination board that does not have anything to do with political interference. In fact, the examination board, as the Bill has established, would ensure that there is transparency, equality and equity for any person who wishes to go through legal education, comes out as a lawyer without any fear or favour.

With this, I want to say that Ghana is blessed at this moment to have our Attorney-General stand up boldly to say that this Bill must come out. I want to commend him again, commend the Committee for the good work done, and commend the institutions that have availed themselves for us to have this Bill presented before this honourable House.

Mr Speaker, I am so grateful for this opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I will now give the floor to Hon James Enu.

Mr James Enu (NDC — Tema West): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity. Let me also add my voice to support the adoption of the Report of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs on the Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025.

Mr Speaker, the current law that regulates legal education now is Act 32 of 1960. So right from the get go, we can easily see that the law has outlived its usefulness because it has been on for more than 60 years.

Mr Speaker, two things are very striking. If we look at our legal education now, there are challenges with access and quality. Now, one of the main purposes of this Bill is to ensure that we are able to increase access and also improve quality. The Bill seeks to establish the Council for Legal Education and Training, which will be responsible for legal training in the country. I think this is a very good step because it takes over something similar to the American system. Prior to this, we had a situation where power, when it comes to the regulation of legal education and the legal profession, was concentrated in the General Legal Council. But now, we are going to break this monopoly of the General Legal Council to ensure that there is shared oversight responsibility. I think that this is a very good step.

So, I pray that the House adopts this report accordingly. I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leadership?

Second Deputy Minority Whip (Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib): Mr Speaker, I would have wished to peruse this Report critically before making some comments. I think legal education needs reform, but there is no need to rush the Report as I indicated earlier. So, I would rather waive any commentaries on this.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Before coming to the Leader, I want to give the floor to Hon Vondee. He is not in the Chamber. Yes, Hon Rockson-Nelson Dafeamekpor, you are not on the list.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, before the Minister comes in—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, you are speaking for Leadership? So, the two of you?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, then I rise on my own merits. *[Laughter]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I am inclined to decline.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, it is a special appeal.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Then you have the floor, in view of the fact that Jerry decided not to contribute.

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor): Mr Speaker, let me indicate that law is a tool for social engineering. It is important that we do this to respond to the current social concerns in the country.

Mr Speaker, for some time now, you and I—I will draw you into this. We weighed this battle from about 2017 to 2018 when news filtered through that there were some issues within the admission protocols of the Ghana School of Law, to the extent that our Committee, of which you were a Deputy Ranking Member at the time, had to be engaged. We made interventions. Eventually, we succeeded in taking the interview out of the process. So, if one writes the exams and succeeds, then he could gain admission.

6:30 p.m.

But another troubling event occurred, to the extent that persons who did not even write the exams at all got admitted, so much so that the General Legal Council itself saw it fit to set up a Disciplinary Committee to look into this matter, and a report was generated. It was established that as many as 11 students or more got in through the back door, which was what was captured in

the report. So, it generated a lot of debates to ask for reforms, and the current Attorney-General, then the Ranking Member, I believe. We even got together to do a Private Member's Bill in the Seventh and Eighth Parliaments. We did not succeed, but today, I am happy we are here.

So, it is important that we bring reforms, but we are not saying it is an easy route to freedom; no. The exams will still be tough, it will still be stiff, but we are opening access. We are increasing the access that persons can have the opportunity to sit for the national bar exams once they are adequately prepared by their various faculties.

Mr Speaker, this is a major policy decision by the Government, and I am happy that the House is prepared to move to adopt the Report by the Committee, and then we will take the Consideration Stage, deal with the issues, and the many amendments that have been proposed, and we can eventually take it through the Third Reading and have it passed.

Mr Speaker, what is important is that in terms of quality, the faculties and the various schools, as they want to be called these days, have been put on notice, because the Deans have been involved, that they must enhance their libraries, enhance the qualifications of faculty members, and among other criteria to be

set by the law. So, they have instituted processes to enable those who do not have those minimum requisite qualifications to quickly do so; it is a major reform.

Mr Speaker, Members will be surprised to hear that some of the Bachelor of Laws (LLB) holders that we produce here, who are denied by some limitations from gaining access to our only professional law school now, travel to Gambia, and they top their class. Even if they do not top their class, they are among the upper quarter qualifying and picking awards. They go to Rwanda, and they pick awards. They go to Malawi and Botswana because we are of the same common law jurisdiction, and they do well. On Sierra Leone, I would leave that for my boss to comment on. We meet our students, and they are passing the Bar in those jurisdictions with flying colours. The tragedy is that when they come back home, they cannot be entered onto the role of lawyers here because they have to do what we call the Post Call, and it is so expensive. I do not know how he has spent £6,000 for many years, equivalent in cedis.

So, they may take the opportunity to go and train in the Law outside, but when they get back home, it is expensive to really do the Post Call, which has become another avenue to sieving or deny person's the opportunity to qualify.

Mr Speaker, I would not say much because the fights, the battles that we waged today, we are seeing it has come to fruition, and we are happy. So, we want to say thank you to all the stakeholders, Mr Speaker, including yourself. I know the things we went through, but we will shepherd this, deal with the amendments, and have it passed so that the reforms can be implemented. We are not saying it is a foolproof system; it will come with some challenges, and we will have the opportunity to tidy them up as we implement the new reform legislation.

Mr Speaker, this is well anchored in Article 25 1(e) of the Constitution. So, it is well anchored in our Constitutional provisions that we must create wider, equitable access and equal opportunities for our educational opportunities that are available in this country.

Mr Speaker, with these words, I thank you for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, let me join Colleagues to recommend to this House to adopt this Report because year after year, the issue of access to professional legal education has been a perennial problem, and this House received several petitions from associations of students

who had written the examination, and had failed to get into the Law school, and felt unfairly treated and at that point, I recall that even the General Legal Council had to cut out some reforms in the examination process with a view to introducing some level of accountability, fairness, and justice in the process. But while it dealt with the issues of accountability in the writing of the exams, the marking of the scripts, and the determination of results, it did not deal fundamentally with the question of access. That question was a function of the structure of the system.

When we were students, we got into the law faculty not automatically; we got into the law faculty after Sixth form. At that time, there was only one law faculty in the whole country: the Law faculty of the University of Ghana. So, all the Sixth form schools in the country, after one wrote A-levels, the Law faculty would take only 100 students for the first year to determine whether one would be a law student to graduate with LLB or not; one had to do well in first-year university exams. If one did well in first-year university exams, one was likely to fall among the first 60, and it is the first 60 who were offered the LLB degree. The rest will be Bachelor of Arts students. They will be sent to all the other faculties, but they will be allowed to do certain courses like jurisprudence *et cetera* at the Law Faculty, which

automatically enables them to go to the Makola, those days we called them the Law school —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Leader, yours is better. In our case, 150 students, and at the end of the first university examination, they will admit 60; 90 must find their way outside the Law Faculty.

Mr Ayariga: So, at different stages, one will see that the mechanism for sieving took place at different levels. In the past, it was getting into the university itself. Once one got into the University Law Faculty and managed to scale through the first year, invariably, all those who scaled through the first year will end up at the Ghana School of Law; that was their practice. Then, later on, as we liberalised, private universities emerged, and they also started running law degree programmes, and their products also wanted to go into *Makola*, and that is how— Initially, there was exams, actually, for mature students; those who had degrees and were workers and wanted to go into *Makola*, wrote exams to come in. But then, as the private universities started offering law degrees, and there was pressure, that was how the system was opened so that they could also participate in the exams in order to get into the Ghana School of Law, and that is when we started having the problems.

So, what the Government has decided to propose to this House to consider is that, since we have liberalised tertiary education, and we have many private universities offering law degrees, and they have been accredited to offer law degrees, then we cannot maintain a monopoly of the legal education programme in the Ghana School of Law; we need to open up that monopoly. So, all the other universities, if they meet the appropriate criteria and standards, they will also be accredited to run programmes that will allow their products to automatically write the Bar exams.

6:40 p.m.

So this is the greatest opportunity that could ever be offered. The only thing is that we must ensure that all those universities that offer law degrees maintain the requisite standards because we do not also want in the process of liberalising, allow standards to fall. That is the major issue that in this Legislation, we must tighten to ensure that law faculties accredited to offer the programme maintain the standards. That way, every university that has a law faculty can have their products write the Bar exams, and then if they pass, they will be called to the Bar. Let me indicate that we are not saying that many more people will pass the Bar exams. We are also not saying that it will lead to an automatic increase in the number of people to be enrolled every year. The

only thing we are guaranteeing is that everybody who has a law degree from a university accredited to offer law will have an opportunity to also write the Bar exams. That I think is what we are guaranteeing.

The second issue of increasing the numbers is a function of the regulators. So, we try as much as possible to look at how we can increase the numbers. If we look at the ratio of lawyers to the population, it is very high. In most jurisdictions, in America, most European countries, and in Canada, we have invariably a ratio of one lawyer to about 300 people in most jurisdictions. Here, the report I am getting is an indication that it is one lawyer to 2,000 people; in fact, some say 5,000. Some say 5,000 to 7,000. But I have also seen statistics that place it at 2,000. If we look at all those who have graduated, we do not know how many who have passed on. But if we look at the roll of lawyers, we may use that. But the question is whether they are actually in the country.

Yes, our statistics may indicate that if we look at all those who have been qualified and then you divide the population by that number, we may get 2,000. But the reality may be that there are many who are not in the jurisdiction. So, the actual ratio could be 5,000 or 7,000 to a lawyer. So, we need to also increase the numbers so that district assemblies, companies, corporations, traditional authorities can all have access to lawyers. In all these places where

there is some administration of justice, what happens invariably is that the absence of lawyers tends to delay proceedings and speedy trials. So, we need to increase the numbers. I recommend to Hon Colleagues that we approve and adopt this Report. Later on, when we go to the Consideration Stage, we will look at all the proposals and find ways of fine-tuning them to produce a legislation that will stand the test of time.

We are not the first to do this. This has been the practice in the United States of America for a very long time, so it is not new. There should not be fears by those in the profession. I have always said that maintaining professional standards is not just a function of the training programme. Professional standards are even better maintained by the judges in the courtroom. This is because when your teachers have finished with a person, depending on how the person passes the examinations— There are many of us who will wait and the day before will commit everything to memory, go, pass, and the following morning we forget. So, depending on how one passes the exams, the training itself in the classroom is no guarantee that one will maintain standards. It is the vigilance of the judges in court that will get the practising lawyers to sit up, do the right thing, and then the standards will improve.

Then the Bar association must also ensure that law firms are well organised so that senior lawyers have time to

mentor and train their junior colleagues so that they will improve the overall performance within the profession. It is a lifelong thing, starting from the training in school to training in the courtroom and training in the law firm and at the Bar. If we just focus on education alone and fear that standards will fall because we are opening the floodgates in terms of access to writing the exams, I do not think that will be a fair analysis. Even in America where they are doing it, there is no indication that professional standards are low.

I urge Hon Colleagues to adopt the Report and I want to commend the Hon Minister for bringing this Bill to Parliament. This is a major promise of the NDC Government. The NDC Government has promised all those holding degrees in law that we will create a fair and equitable platform that will enable them to be called to the Bar, and we are living up to our promises and our commitments. That is why this Bill is here.

I want to assure the students out there that we will do whatever it takes within this Meeting of this Parliament to have this legislation enacted into law. I thank you very much Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, before putting the Question and to avoid taking part in the debate, some of us have suffered a lot and can only say this Bill is coming at the right time. Hon Members, there were

instances where in the Budgets, it would be indicated the number of students that will be enrolled into the Ghana School of Law and at the same time they will indicate the number of students that will fail. So, sitting in the middle of the third row, we have difficulties. This was because if we say 200 students will be admitted but out of the 200 students 100 will be called to the Bar before the examination even takes place, that tells me that about 100 will fail. We had our own challenges, and I believe this is the way to address the issue. With this, I will put a Question—

Attorney General and Minister for Justice, do you want to conclude?

Dr Ayine: Mr Speaker, I want to take the opportunity to thank Hon Members, the able Chairperson of my Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs, for the good work that has been done on this Bill, and for all the commendations. I was very happy that my Hon Colleague, Hon Anthony Mmieh, said that this was a wonderful opportunity. Coming from the opposition, I thought that was very reassuring. This is because the Bill, as the Hon Majority Leader has pointed out, accords with the letter in spirit of the 1992 Constitution in Article 25 to create equality of opportunity for every one of our citizens desirous of becoming lawyers. The Hon Majority Leader has described how strenuous it was for people to become lawyers in the past. But though it was a very strenuous

system, it also guaranteed automatic entry to the law school if one was qualified enough to go through the LLB programme. What this Bill does is to clear the bottleneck, which is the monopoly of the Ghana School of Law, and also the so-called entrance exam that made it virtually impossible for even students who graduated with First-Class from very reputable universities to get into the Ghana School of Law.

6:50 p.m.

So, Mr Speaker, the innovations introduced by this Bill are very clear for everyone to see. We are introducing an accreditation programme that will make sure that it is not every mushroom LLB school that will produce lawyers who will go on to write the bar exam. There will be accreditation and quality control to ensure that if there is a university producing LLB candidates, those candidates would have gone through a training that is either equivalent to or better than what I went through or what the Majority Leader went through before becoming lawyers.

Mr Speaker, we are also introducing the National Bar Examination so that those who go through the law practice training course at the accredited universities, can all write the National Bar Examination, which will be a standardised exam that will be administered by the Council for Legal Education and its Bar Examination Committee.

Mr Speaker, the Hon Majority Leader has already made it abundantly clear that it is not true that this country has too many lawyers. There is this misperception out there that there are too many lawyers in this country. As the Hon Majority Leader has pointed out, in the United States of America (USA), the lawyer-to-resident or citizen ratio is four lawyers to 1,000 residents or 1,000 citizens in America. Here, it is one lawyer to over 5,000 citizens. So, Mr Speaker, there is no oversupply of lawyers in this country.

So, what the Government of His Excellency John Dramani Mahama is doing is to create a system that will provide equality of opportunity for everyone who desires to be a lawyer but at the same time maintain quality control such that we will be producing some of the best lawyers on this planet Earth. I urge everyone to support the Motion for the Adoption of the Report and also to actively take part, especially the lawyers, in the refinement of the Bill so that when it comes out and it is passed into law, it will be one that will stand the test of time.

Mr Speaker, I thank you very much for this opportunity and I thank Members for their participation.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025
accordingly read a Second Time.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think we were scheduled to start at 12 noon. So, as

far as the records are concerned, it was 12 noon. We were late, but it was 12 noon Technically, we have done five hours, so, we are in your hands.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Leader, I beg to differ. So, you may move a Motion for adjournment.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I beg to move that this House be adjourned to tomorrow at 12 noon.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 6:52 p.m. till Wednesday, 4th February, 2026 at 12 noon.